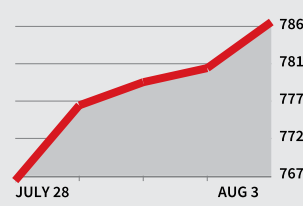


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 78639.03 (+544.39)

IN FOCUS



	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24774.30	+390.70
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.98	+0.16
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.33	-0.05
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	141986.00	-302
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	217287.00	-1008

REGULATORY REFORM.

Proposed Seed Bill may include gene editing, providing legal clarity and avoiding regulatory hurdles faced by GM crops **p10**



GAME-CHANGER.

Anthropic's Claude to process queries within India via Amazon Bedrock **p14**

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Closing price discovery catches traders off-guard as CAS lifts Nifty 200 points

CHANGING MATH. The top 10 stocks contributed around 30 per cent of the total CAS turnover on NSE

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The Nifty 50's official closing value surged nearly 200 points after continuous trading ended on Monday, surprising market participants on Day 1 of the Closing Auction Session (CAS) for futures and options (F&O) stocks.

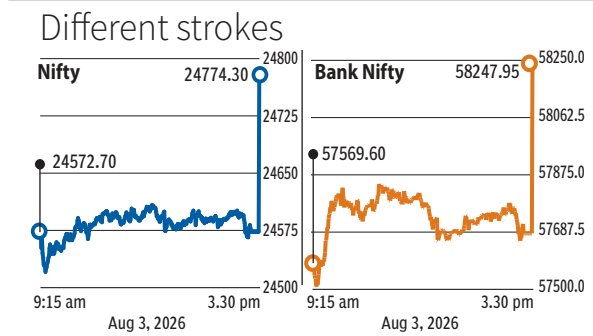
The Nifty 50 ended at 24,774.30, up 390.70 points (1.6 per cent), with almost half the gain coming during the closing auction. Heavyweights such as ICICI Bank, HDFC Bank, Reliance Industries, Infosys, Bharti Airtel and Bajaj Finance saw heavy

buying on the NSE. Share prices of several companies saw a huge difference between the Nifty spot and F&O price.

For instance, the Bajaj Auto spot price closed at ₹11,856 whereas August future is ₹11,546, a difference of ₹310 — 10 minutes earlier, the spot price was in discount of about ₹20 against the August future price.

The BSE Sensex rose 549.62 points to 78,639. The NSE recorded a CAS turnover of ₹1,276.2 crore compared with just ₹10.8 crore on the BSE.

While easing West Asian tensions and softer crude oil prices supported sentiment



during the day, the sharp jump in the benchmark's official closing value came during the newly introduced CAS, which began after 3.15 pm and lasted till 3.40 pm.

Under the SEBI's revised

framework, the official closing prices of F&O stocks are now determined through a 20-minute closing auction, replacing the earlier volume-weighted average price methodology.

INSTITUTIONAL FLOWS

Hariselman Radhakrishnan, Founder and CEO, HST Wealth, said: "When large institutional orders are concentrated in this auction window, prices can move quickly in the final minutes, especially if there is aggressive buying or short covering in heavyweight Nifty constituents." Hitesh Tailor, Technical and Derivative Analyst at Choice Broking, said institutional, passive fund and algorithmic trades shifted to the closing auction, where they were matched against a relatively thinner order book, pushing index heavyweights sharply higher at final settlement.

Govt to offload up to 6.54% in LIC, likely to raise over ₹31,000 crore

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The government on Monday announced the sale of up to 6.54 per cent of its stake in the Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) through the offer-for-sale (OFS) route.

Based on the floor price, the issue is expected to fetch over ₹31,600 crore, making it the largest mop-up through an OFS so far.

"Offer-for-Sale in LIC opens tomorrow for non-retail investors. Retail investors can bid on Wednesday. Government offers to disinvest 2.5 per cent equity with an additional 4 per cent as a greenshoe option. Floor price has been fixed at ₹382 per share," Arunish Chawla, Secretary, Department of

Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM), said in a post on social media.

He added that the stake sale would help LIC achieve the minimum public shareholding (MPS) requirement ahead of schedule.

PUBLIC FLOAT TO RISE

The revised timeline for achieving 10 per cent public shareholding is on or before May 16, 2027.

At present, public holding is 3.5 per cent, which will go up to 10 per cent after completion of the OFS.

Apart from up to 6.5 per cent holding proposed to be offloaded, the notice to the exchange also mentions that additionally 50 lakh shares (equivalent to 0.04 per cent of the total issued and paid-up equity share

capital of the Corporation) may be offered to eligible employees of LIC.

This will take the total dilution up to 6.54 per cent and based on the floor price, the government can get over ₹31,600 crore.

According to Chawla, LIC remains a cornerstone of India's financial sector as the country's largest life insurer and the second-largest public sector enterprise by market capitalisation.

DISINVESTMENT RECEIPTS

The LIC stake sale is the ninth OFS undertaken by the government in the current financial year.

Through the eight earlier OFS and receipts from SUUTI, the government has mobilised over ₹21,000 crore so far.

Centre moves to impose MDR on UPI, extend tax breaks for contract manufacture

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The government has initiated amendments to the existing statutory framework to levy Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI payments for large merchants.

Simultaneously, to bolster domestic electronics manufacturing and benefit global majors like Apple, the Centre proposes to extend, until 2041, tax breaks for foreign companies supplying machinery to contract manufacturers.

The proposals are part of the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, which is expected to be tabled in Parliament on Tuesday. *businessline* has viewed the proposed Bill that seeks to amend the Income-Tax Act, 2025, the Payment and Set-

tlement Act, 2007, and the Finance Act, 2026, beside repealing the Income-tax (Amendment) Ordinance, 2026, to provide tax exemption to foreign investors on interest and capital gains from G-Secs.

FREE REGIME TO END

The government has introduced amendments to the Payments Regulatory Board/ Payments Act framework that will change how fee-free payment instruments are designated. At present, the law effectively prohibits MDR on UPI and RuPay debit card transactions.

The proposed amendment will instead empower the Centre to notify which payment instruments will remain exempt from charges, rather than hard-coding the exemption in the law.

The Finance Ministry has

proposed repealing the amendment of Section 10A, which mandated that banks and payment companies should not levy MDR on UPI payments.

MDR is a fee that businesses pay to banks and payment service providers for processing digital transactions. The proposals do not involve charging consumers for using UPI.

"In Clause 2 of the Bill, in the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, amendment of Section 10A in order to remove the reference of provision of Income Tax Act and also to provide that no bank or system provider shall impose, whether directly or indirectly, any charge upon a person making or receiving a payment by using one or more electronic modes of payment as may be notified by the Central gov-

ernment," the Bill said.

ELECTRONICS MAKERS

To provide certainty to electronic manufacturers, the Bill proposes to replace the broad reference to 'electronic goods' with a defined list of 'specified electronic goods' and extend the tax exemption by 10 years up to tax year 2040-41 from FY31. The exemption will be made available to 'the contract manufacturer producing specified electronic goods on behalf of the foreign company for a consideration'.

Also, the expression 'specified electronic goods' includes mobile phones, laptops, all-in-one personal computers and tablets, servers and ultra small form factor (USFF) or sub-assemblies to the finished goods mentioned.

Also read **p7**

Private banks top FCNR (B) mobilisation led by ICICI; State Bank leads among PSBs

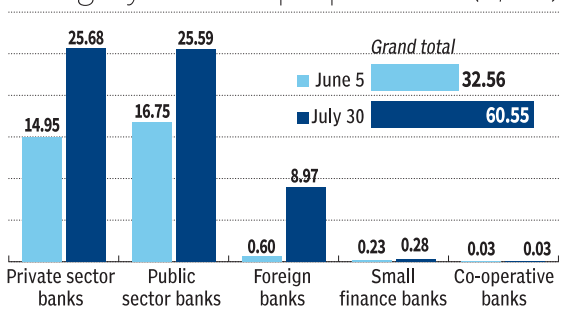
Our Bureau
Mumbai

Private sector banks outperformed public sector banks (PSBs) in mobilising Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) [FCNR(B)] deposits with maturities of 3-5 years under the Reserve Bank of India's limited-period US dollar-rupee forex swap facility, according to data tabled in the Lok Sabha.

Top five banks account for 62.5 per cent of total FCNR deposits. Foreign banks, led by HSBC and Standard Chartered Bank (SCB), collectively mobilised almost as much as all 12 PSBs combined during the June 5-July 30, 2026, window.

Among the 20 private sector banks, ICICI Bank, Kotak Mahindra Bank, Axis Bank and HDFC Bank each mobilised more than \$1 billion through FCNR(B) deposits.

Category-wise mop-up (in \$ billion)



Source: RBI, as provided in Lok Sabha on Aug 3, 2026

In comparison, only the State Bank of India (SBI) and Bank of Baroda (BoB) crossed the \$1 billion mark among the 12 PSBs.

Across all 42 participating banks, HSBC emerged as the largest mobiliser with \$6.14 billion, followed by SBI (\$4.12 billion) and ICICI Bank (\$3.69 billion) in FCNR (B) deposits from non-resident Indians (NRIs).

Private sector banks col-

lectively mobilised \$10.73 billion, with six lenders accounting for the bulk of the inflows — ICICI Bank (\$3.69 billion), Kotak Mahindra Bank (\$1.65 billion), Axis Bank (\$1.58 billion), HDFC Bank (\$1.40 billion), Yes Bank (\$810.39 million) and RBL Bank (\$556.68 million).

The PSBs, meanwhile, raised \$8.84 billion. Besides SBI and BoB, only Punjab National Bank (\$969.63 mil-

lion), Canara Bank (\$933.47 million) and Indian Bank (\$835.87 million) mobilised more than \$500 million.

FOREIGN BANKS

Among the 12 foreign banks participating in the scheme, HSBC dominated with \$6.14 billion, while Standard Chartered Bank was the only other lender to cross the \$1 billion milestone, raising \$1.85 billion.

Industry experts attributed the stronger performance of select private and foreign banks to their ability to offer higher leverage and better overall returns, measured as deposit interest earned after adjusting for the cost of leverage.

Large private lenders such as HDFC Bank and ICICI Bank also boosted FCNR(B) mobilisation by raising deposit rates by 25 basis points, from 6 per cent to 6.25 per cent, during the scheme.

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QUICKLY.

A ‘defining milestone’ for paper business: ITC’s Puri



Kolkata: ITC CMD Sanjiv Puri reported the acquisition of Century Pulp and Paper marks a “defining milestone” for the company’s paper business, with the ₹3,498-crore deal making ITC India’s largest integrated paperboards and paper business. **PTI**

DLF Q1 profit rises 4% despite fall in income

New Delhi: Realty major DLF Ltd reported a 4 per cent increase in its consolidated net profit to ₹793.90 crore for the quarter ended June despite a fall in total income. Its net profit stood at ₹762.67 crore in the year-ago period. Total income declined to ₹1,605.56 crore (₹12,980.88 crore), according to a regulatory filing. **PTI**

GSK Pharma Q1 profit up 16% to ₹237.18 crore



New Delhi: GlaxoSmithKline Pharmaceuticals reported a 16 per cent rise in consolidated net profit to ₹237.18 crore in the first quarter ended June 30, 2026. It had posted a consolidated net profit of ₹205 crore in the corresponding period of the preceding financial year, the company said in a regulatory filing. Consolidated revenue from operations stood at ₹938.44 crore (₹805.17 crore). **PTI**

Essar Group’s \$5.8 b investment backs UK’s energy transition: Prashant Ruia

AMBITIOUS PLANS. Focus on hydrogen, cleaner refining, retail expansion and new industries

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Essar Energy Transition’s (EET’s) investment pipeline of £4.3 billion, or roughly \$5.8 billion, plays a critical role in accelerating the UK’s low-carbon transformation, supporting the government’s decarbonisation policy and creating highly-skilled employment opportunities at the heart of the North West, said Prashant Ruia, Chairman of EET, on Monday.

“Our £4.3-billion investment pipeline represents a significant growth opportunity for the UK, supporting the country’s energy transition, generating massive long-term economic value, and creating thousands of highly-skilled jobs built on the site’s proud industrial heritage,” Ruia noted.

Essar Group-backed EET has an investment pipeline

of £4.3 billion to develop a range of low-carbon energy transition projects in the UK until 2035. The company celebrates 15 years of ownership and stewardship of the Stanlow Manufacturing Complex, one of Europe’s leading refining assets.

STANLOW REFINERY
In 2011, Essar acquired Stanlow and committed to a long-term modernisation strategy. Over the past 15 years, Essar’s £1-billion investment has reshaped the refinery, ensuring it retained its position as a critical national asset.

Key upgrades include re-configuring the site to a highly-efficient single-train operation to increase yields of higher-value products, expanding the range of crude grades processed, and upgrading Stanlow’s catalytic cracker.

Owned and operated by EET Fuels, a wholly-owned division of Essar Group, the



CRITICAL ASSET. Essar is celebrating 15 years of ownership and stewardship of the Stanlow Manufacturing Complex **BLOOMBERG**

company recently completed a £100-million (\$130-million) refinery turnaround, increasing throughput by around 8 per cent.

The company also commissioned the UK’s first hydrogen-ready refinery furnace following a £70.9-million (\$100-million) investment, marking a major milestone in the site’s transition to low-carbon operations.

Stanlow is a vital economic engine; recent independent analysis showed that it supports around 5,000 UK jobs (direct, indirect and induced), with average employee salaries double the national average and a UK supply chain spend of £426 million.

FUTURE GROWTH
Essar is now rewriting the fu-

ture of Stanlow, harnessing the strength of its refining capability and building new industries through ambitious growth plans.

“Advancing a £4.3-billion investment pipeline, with over £1 billion nearing a Final Investment Decision (FID), to transform Stanlow into a world-leading energy transition hub. Hydrogen production is central to this plan,” the company said.

Besides, it is massively expanding its retail network, targeting 800 new locations directly supplied by the refinery and growing the reach and presence of the Essar brand.

The company is also actively exploring next-generation expansion opportunities to maximise the site’s vast capacity. This includes assessing the potential for hosting state-of-the-art commercial data centres on the extensive Stanlow plot, powered directly by onsite hydrogen-ready generation.

‘India witnessing strong traction for premium TVs’

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Sony India is eyeing revenues of ₹10,000 crore as it is witnessing stronger traction for premium televisions in India, which it considers to be a strategic market. The Japanese consumer electronics major, on Monday, launched its flagship Bravia 91I line-up, with the introduction of its new 115 (292 cm), the largest Bravia television ever by Sony.

“Premiumisation is gaining traction in India and the average selling price is in-



Sunil Nayyar (right), MD, Sony India, and Nezu Daisuke (left), Global Head of Home Product Business Division, Home Entertainment Business Unit, Sony Corporation

creasing. So, we are hopeful of achieving a target of ₹10,000 crore in terms of revenues in a couple of years,” Sunil Nayyar, Man-

aging Director, Sony India, told *businessline*.

“India is a key strategic market for Sony. We are seeing strong double-digit growth in the large and super-large TV segment. The 55 inches and above market is shaping very well in the country and witnessing growth in the range of 30-40 per cent,” he added.

PREMIUM TVS
Nayyar said that in the 65-inch, 75-inch and 85-inch segments, the company has been witnessing even stronger growth. “Demand for premium televisions is coming not just in metros and large cities but is also equally good in tier-2 and tier-3 towns. Consumers are increasingly willing to spend

Generation biz drags Torrent Power Q1 profit

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Torrent Power reported an almost 13 per cent year-on-year decline in consolidated profit for the first quarter of FY27, as weaker performance from its generation business offset growth in transmission, distribution and renewable energy (RE) segments.

The company’s consolidated profit attributable to owners declined to ₹639 crore during the quarter from ₹731 crore in the year-ago quarter. Revenue from operations, however, rose 2.9 per cent to ₹8,124 crore (₹7,894 crore).

The decline in profitability was largely driven by the generation segment, where revenue fell 31 per cent during the quarter. The segment includes power generation from thermal sources, including gas and coal, as well as trading of regasified liquefied natural gas (LNG).The

company said disruptions in LNG supplies affected the operations of its thermal power plants during the quarter.

In contrast, Torrent Power’s transmission and distribution business reported an 11 per cent increase in revenue, supported by its licensed distribution operations, franchisee businesses and related ancillary services.

Revenue from the RE segment grew 18 per cent during the quarter, reflecting the company’s continued expansion in wind and solar power generation.

Torrent Power stated in an official release that its EBITDA grew 2 per cent despite a challenging operating environment, marked by geopolitical disruptions that impacted LNG supplies and, consequently, the performance of its thermal power plants.

The company said the performance was supported by stronger contributions from



its distribution and RE businesses, with EBITDA growth of 10 per cent and 6 per cent, respectively.

NABHA POWER
The quarter also saw Torrent Power complete the acquisition of Nabha Power from Larsen & Toubro’s wholly-owned subsidiary L&T

Power Development. The acquisition, completed on June 25, was valued at ₹3,632.35 crore.

Nabha Power operates a 2x700 MW coal-based super-critical thermal power plant in Punjab and has long-term power purchase agreements with Punjab State Power Corporation for 25 years, effective 2014. Following the completion of the transaction, Nabha Power became a wholly-owned subsidiary of Torrent Power.

The company said the acquisition has been accounted for under Ind AS 103 relating to business combinations, with the purchase price allocation exercise currently underway based on provisional fair values of assets and liabilities acquired. For the period from the acquisition date until June 30, Nabha Power contributed revenue from operations of ₹68.64 crore and profit of ₹7.62 crore to Torrent Power’s consolidated results.

Torrent Power to retire Ahmedabad’s iconic 362-MW Sabarmati thermal plant by 2030

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

Torrent Power is planning to permanently shut its 362-MW coal-fired AMGEN power plant in Ahmedabad’s Sabarmati area by December 2030 and replace it with a significantly larger thermal unit that could be built outside Gujarat, marking the end of one of the country’s oldest operating power stations.

The plant, located on the Sabarmati riverfront, sits next to the Sardar Patel Sports Enclave, which is being readied to host the 2030 Commonwealth Games, and overlooks the upcoming Sabarmati bullet train station across the road. Its eventual closure would remove one of the last large coal-fired generating stations from the heart of Ahmedabad.

“The AMGEN power project is about 362-MW capacity. We have permission to run it up to December 2030. After December 2030, it is not going to be in operation,” a senior Torrent Power official told investors during the company’s post-results earnings call on Monday evening.

“We have requested the State government for double the coal allocation for the capacity of 362 MW. The State government has approved the coal, but they have requested the Central government for the coal allocation. Once the Central government approves the coal al-



location for this plant, we plan to set up close to 800-MW unit to replace the AMGEN power project,” the official said.

OUTSIDE GUJARAT
While the replacement project is intended to continue supplying Torrent’s Ahmedabad distribution network, the new plant may not necessarily be located in Gujarat.

“We are working out where exactly to place the plant. It may not be in Gujarat. We are working on where this new plant will be come up. It is work in progress right now,” the company’s management said, adding that Torrent will finalise its investment plans once the coal allocation is approved.

The move comes against the backdrop of tightening environmental regulations. Under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate

Change’s notification issued in December 2024, the plant is exempt from installing flue gas desulphurisation systems only until its planned retirement on December 31, 2030.

The AMGEN plant remains a critical embedded generation asset for Torrent’s licensed distribution business in Ahmedabad and operates under a regulated tariff framework approved by the Gujarat Electricity Regulatory Commission. The station traces its origins to 1934, when the first generating units were commissioned at Sabarmati to supply electricity to Ahmedabad.

Over successive expansions and modernisation, it evolved into the current 362-MW configuration comprising three units of around 120 MW each, making it one of India’s oldest continuously operating thermal power stations.

Ather Energy narrows Q1 loss to ₹51 cr

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Ather Energy reported a sharp improvement in its financial performance for Q1FY27, with consolidated net loss narrowing to ₹51.1 crore from ₹178.2 crore a year earlier, aided by robust sales growth and improved operating efficiencies. Its consolidated total income rose 87.2 per cent year-on-year to ₹1,260 crore (₹673 crore), while revenue from operations nearly doubled to ₹1,216.9 crore (₹644.6 crore). The company posted a consolidated EBITDA of ₹9 crore during the quarter, compared with an EBITDA loss of ₹106 crore a year ago, with EBITDA margin improving 1,650 basis points to 0.8 per cent.

Ather delivered 83,173 electric scooters during the quarter, an increase of 80.5 per cent, as customer demand continued to outpace production capacity.



HIGHER SALES
Ather attributed the strong revenue growth to higher sales volumes, calibrated price increases and a growing contribution from non-vehicle businesses — software subscriptions, charging services, accessories, spares and after-sales service. Despite higher input costs due to rising prices of copper, aluminium, lithium and crude-linked materials, its adjusted gross margin rose 82.3 per cent to ₹282 crore.

Demand remained strong across the electric two-wheeler industry, with registrations increasing 68 per cent to about 5.25 lakh units during the quarter, according to Vahan data.

To support future growth, the company said Phase I of its Factory 3.0 at AURIC in Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar remains on track to commence production in the third quarter of FY27. The facility will add annual production capacity of five lakh units, taking the company closer to its planned manufacturing capacity of one million electric two-wheelers annually. The company is also set to unveil the first production scooter built on its new EL platform at Ather Community Day on August 29.

“We continued to see strong demand across our portfolio, as structural tailwinds from both policy support and shifting customer sentiment translated into a massive upsurge for our products, with demand far outstripping supply. This gives us confidence that the market continues to expand,” said Tarun Mehta, Co-Founder and CEO, Ather Energy.

Michelin bets on India’s premium mobility boom

Our Bureau
Chennai

French tyre-maker Michelin sees India emerging as a key manufacturing and technology hub for its global operations, with its Chennai plant set to cater to both domestic demand and overseas markets in future, as production ramps up.

Victor Silva, President, Michelin - Africa, India and Middle East, said the decision to manufacture passenger car tyres in India is driven by the company’s long-term strategy rather than production costs. The company is strengthening its long-term commitment to India by expanding local manufacturing to cater to the country’s fast-growing premium passenger vehicle segment, he said. Michelin commercially launched its first passenger car tyre manufactured at its Chennai plant on Monday.



(from left) Victor Silva, President, Michelin Africa, India and Middle East Region; Shantanu Deshpande, MD, Michelin India, and Jean-François Rene, ED, Michelin, Chennai **BUJOY GHOSH**

“The reason for us to produce in India is not just on cost. Initially, the tyre will actually be slightly more expensive for us to manufacture because of the investments that have gone into the new facility. But the price for consumers will not change. Our pricing is based on the value the product delivers, not where it is manufactured,” Silva said.

He said the move reflects Michelin’s “local-to-local” strategy of manufacturing products closer to key markets while leveraging India as an important production base.

PREMIUMISATION
Shantanu Deshpande, Managing Director, Michelin India, said the company is responding to India’s rapid premiumisation in mobility, with consumers increasingly opting for larger SUVs and demanding higher standards

of safety, comfort and performance.

He said Michelin has fulfilled a commitment made around 18 months ago to localise passenger car tyre production. The company will initially manufacture tyres in 16-inch to 22-inch sizes, focusing on the premium replacement market before expanding supplies to original equipment (OE) manufacturers.

Jean-François Rene, Executive Director, Michelin Chennai, said passenger car tyre production at the Chennai facility commenced in June after a year-long installation and commissioning process.

The plant uses the same machinery, raw materials and quality standards as Michelin’s global manufacturing facilities, he added.

While the immediate priority is meeting domestic demand, the facility will also support exports to Africa, West Asia, North America

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CIN No.: L29301KA1999PLC025387



Revenue

4,805.83 mn
+ 41.3%

EBITDA

537.51 mn
+50.9%

PAT

170.56 mn
+63.5%

1. Key financial information

(Rs. In million, except per share data)

Sr. No	Particulars	Quarter Ended		Year Ended
		30th June 2026	30th June 2025	30th March 2026
		Unaudited	Unaudited	Audited
1	Revenue from Operations	4,805.83	3,401.07	16,074.24
2	EBITDA*	537.51	356.21	1,661.35
3	Profit Before Tax	224.78	133.43	509.83
4	Profit After Tax for the period	170.56	104.33	419.91
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period	169.35	103.13	422.47
6	Paid up Equity Share Capital (Face Value of Rs.10/- each)	331.07	330.76	331.07
7	Earnings per Share** Basic (in Rs.) (Face value of Rs. 10 each)	5.15	3.15	12.69
8	Earnings per Share** Diluted (in Rs.) (Face value of Rs. 10 each)	5.15	3.15	12.69

* Excludes Other Income and Other gains and losses.

Note :

- a. The statement of unaudited financial results for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 were reviewed and recommended by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at their respective meetings held on August 03, 2026.
- b. The Financial Statements have been prepared in accordance with Indian Accounting Standards ("IndAS) prescribed by section 133 of the Companies Act 2013 and in terms of Regulation 33 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015
- c. The above is an extract of the detailed format of unaudited financial results filed with the stock exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the unaudited financial results are available on the Stock Exchange websites www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com and on the company's website www.stovekraft.com.



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Place : Bengaluru

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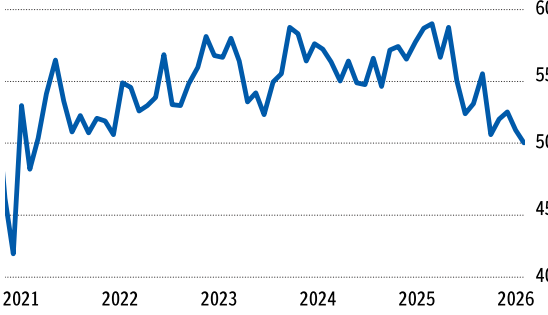
— Launching —
iVO
Healthify Airfryer



- Glass window for convenient monitoring
- Digital display for ease of use
- Multi-mode cooking
- Even, efficient heating system
- 5.4L basket

Manufacturing
PMI slips to near
5-year low in July

Growth falters



Sources: HSBC, S&P Global PMI Data were collected July 8-27, 2026

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The manufacturing sector moderated in July as the Purchasing Manager's Index for the month slipped to a five-year low of 53.5 as against 54.2 in June, S&P Global reported on Monday.

Job creation also weakened in July.

The index is below the long-run series average of 54.2. According to the agency, manufacturers in India continued to benefit from demand resilience, with a sustained rise in new orders underpinning a further expansion in output during July.

WEST ASIA CONFLICT

"However, growth cooled across some metrics, such as total sales, input purchasing and employment," it said.

"The suppliers' delivery times index rose in July, an encouraging sign that supply chain delays are continuing to unwind. However, renewed tensions in West Asia have raised fresh doubts about how durable these improvements will be," Pranjul Bhandari, Chief India Economist at HSBC, said.

Further, manufacturers appear to be rebuilding buffers; inventories of both in-

puts and finished goods increased alongside a rise in purchasing volumes, suggesting firms are securing supply and limiting exposure to potential disruption.

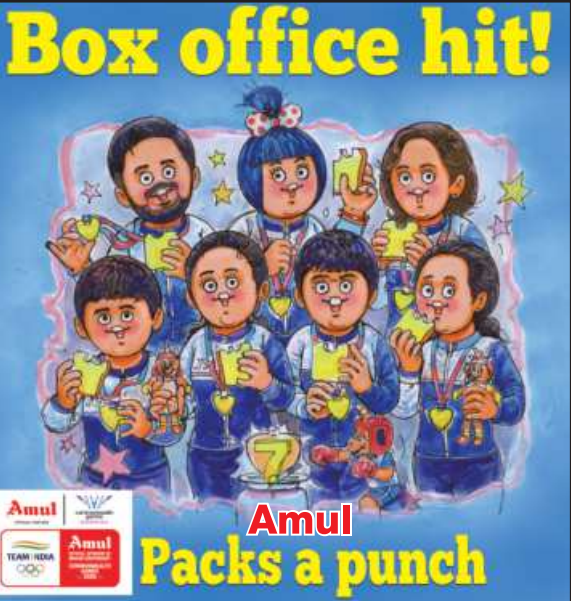
In terms of operating capacity, the agency noted that only a small proportion of firms indicated greater backlog of work.

The overall rate of accumulation was the strongest in a year, albeit only slight overall.

"Job creation across India's manufacturing industry weakened for the third straight month in July. The rate of increase in employment was the slowest in the current 29-month period of uninterrupted growth," it said, while adding that cost pressures receded to their weakest in five months, though companies continued to report higher prices for transportation, in particular.

Talking about business sentiment, the agency highlighted that it strengthened from June's recent low, with firms signalling a positive outlook for demand, infrastructure projects and new client enquiries.

Bhandari said output and new export orders strengthened, pointing to resilient demand, particularly from overseas markets.



deCunha/AB/1125

India, Uzbekistan aim to
double bilateral trade in 3 years

Our Bureau
New Delhi

India and Uzbekistan have set ambitious targets to sharply expand bilateral trade and investment, with New Delhi proposing to double two-way trade over the next three years, from about \$1.3 billion at present, while Tashkent said it hoped to raise the figure to \$2 billion by next year.

At a business forum meeting on Monday, the two countries identified mining, pharmaceuticals and healthcare, information technology, food processing and the digital economy as priority sectors for deeper collaboration.

Uzbekistan also pitched opportunities in metallurgy, chemicals, energy, automobiles and digital infrastructure.

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said the recently signed bilateral investment treaty would boost investor confidence. "The recent bilateral investment treaty between India and Uzbekistan generates greater investor confidence. Areas to build strong collaboration between the two countries include mining,



Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal (right) with Uzbekistan Minister Laziz Kudratov PTI

textiles, pharmaceuticals and healthcare, agriculture and food processing along with IT and digital economy," he said.

The event was organised by industry chamber Ficci in partnership with the Ministry of Commerce and Industry and Uzbekistan's Ministry of Investment, Industry and Trade.

Uzbekistan's Minister of Investment, Industry and Trade Laziz Kudratov said bilateral trade had grown by about 30 per cent last year to reach \$1.3 billion for the first time.

He expressed hope that it would touch \$2 billion next year, before rising to \$3-5 billion in the coming years.



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Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

Growth engine

IIP signals resilience to external challenges

Since the Iran conflict broke out in February, the market narrative has turned quite gloomy about the prospects for the economy — the energy shock adding to the prevailing pessimism over AI disruption and tariffs. However, macro indicators are telling a very different story about India’s resilience.



A key indicator which suggests that the animal spirits are very much alive, in some sectors, is the Index of Industrial Production (IIP). After dipping to 3.2 per cent in March 2026, year-on-year growth in the IIP improved to 4.9 per cent in April and 5 per cent in May. The latest June reading of 7.3 per cent is at a 23-month high. A deeper dive into the data suggests that the manufacturing momentum displayed by the index is not just real, but sustainable. The use-based classification shows five of the six sub-segments of the IIP performing better in April-June 2026 compared to the same quarter last year. Capital goods expanded at an impressive 14 per cent (8.8 per cent last year), while intermediate goods (8.5 versus 5 per cent) and infrastructure/construction (6.8 versus 6.1 per cent) also put up a strong show. In fact, consumer non-durables was the only segment which didn’t improve upon last year’s growth. High growth rates were achieved by segments such as electrical equipment (25.8 per cent growth), motor vehicles and transport equipment (15 per cent growth each), computers and electronic products (12.5 per cent) and consumer durables (7.2 per cent versus 2.8 per cent).

There are other notable features. Results from listed firms seem to suggest that India has been making substantial strides in energy transition. This shows up in overflowing orders for power and electrical equipment makers. Vehicle sales have grown strongly in double digits even after the upward revision in fuel prices consequent to the Iran war. Costlier fuels have accelerated the pace of EV (electric vehicle) adoption, triggering a 15 per cent growth in motor vehicles and related industries in Q1. Electronics manufacturing has continued to benefit from the indigenisation push and production-linked incentives. At the same time, the late start to the monsoon and prolonged heat wave have sharply propped up demand for air conditioners and cooling systems this year.

The IIP revamp in June underscores these trends. The revised IIP, for instance, captures gas and water supply and waste management which were earlier not covered under ‘Utilities’. The head ‘Electricity’ now granularly measures power generated from both renewable and non-renewable sources. Weights for electrical equipment, motor vehicles and electronic products — fast-growing segments — are higher in the new IIP. The base year revision and the expansion in the item basket (from 407 to 463) are likely to have brought more contemporary products into the ambit of the index. This is a story of resilience and structural transformation in the face of external shock. Policy initiatives should keep this manufacturing momentum going.

OTHER VOICES.

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

EUROPE

Trump’s latest Iran ‘Deal’

A friend quipped the other day that President Trump truly deserves the Nobel Peace Prize because he has already ended the Iran war eight times. Will the ninth time be the charm after his latest decision to call off a military escalation in search of a deal with the revolutionary regime? “We have just been asked by Iran, and other Middle Eastern Countries, to hold off any attack in that the perimeters of a deal has been agreed to,” Mr. Trump posted on Saturday. He added that this includes “Immediate, Complete, and Total” opening of the Strait of Hormuz and an end to Iran’s nuclear program. (NEW YORK, AUGUST 2)



Manila’s double game puts peace at risk

The contradictory approach the Philippines adopts in its handling of maritime disputes makes one wonder what exactly Manila is hoping to achieve. The recent remarks of Philippine Defense Secretary Gilberto Teodoro Jr serve as the latest evidence of such inconsistency. According to reports, Teodoro Jr, who has already been sanctioned by Beijing for making unfounded remarks which undermined China’s interests and bilateral ties between China and the Philippines, called for Philippine officials “who side with China” on the “West Philippine Sea issue” to resign at a forum on July 29, ignoring the fact that the “West Philippine Sea” is just a term unilaterally coined by Manila to support its unlawful claims in the South China Sea. (BEIJING, AUGUST 3)

Monetary policy: Responding to the times

BEST BET. A data-based pause and continuation of neutral stance is ideal, while waiting for current uncertainty to resolve



ASHIMA GOYAL

There is an impressive consensus among economists and analysts for the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) to give a pause in repo rates. Normally, in an emerging market (EM) under pressure from global volatility, with headline inflation crossing the inflation target, there should be calls to raise rates!

Putting core forecasts in the public domain may have helped moderate analysts’ inflation expectations. June headline inflation came in at 4.4 per cent but core inflation was only 2.5 per cent, implying there is no sign of generalised excess demand. It is increasingly recognised that volatile components revert to a more stable trend. Firms’ pass-through of commodity price spikes has also fallen in the inflation targeting regime and can be expected to be muted to the extent consumer confidence and spending fall in difficult times.

There is more of an understanding of inflation targeting and that temporary spikes can be looked through, with the tolerance band giving the space to accommodate such spikes.

While the monsoon has picked up in the key planting month of July the Middle East tensions continue. But countries and the oil market are finding substitution possibilities as well as ways to keep oil flowing. Crude oil futures are in the early eighties while the MPC had taken the value of 95. There may even be room to reduce headline inflation forecasts. However, if inflation rises persistently, the MPC will act to ensure inflation expectations remain anchored. How much pass-through there is and how persistent the commodity shocks are, remains to be seen.

Growth has held up well despite global shocks, but there is some softening and it is below potential. Moreover, aspirational youth are

restless for progress. Signs of a broad-based revival in the private sector investment cycle also need support.

Using policy to counter global shocks is essential for this. A data-based pause and continuation of the neutral stance is best, while waiting for current high levels of uncertainty to resolve.

FINANCIAL CONDITIONS

The measures in the last policy are enabling banks to raise interest rates for NRIs and help solve the mismatch in deposit and credit growth without a general rise in interest rates. The rupee has more support, which is the dominant factor to attract fixed income flows.

As a result G-sec yields are also softening, which will help the interrupted transmission of lower repo rates. Interest differential with the US has come down from around 5 per cent in end-2023 to around 2 per cent but is adequate as risk and inflation have fallen in India, but risen in the US. Spreads still exceed the average EM spread of 2 per cent.

Both the rupee and G-sec yields have suffered from adverse sentiments more than from real weakness — so demonstration of levers to attract multiple types of inflows is a confidence builder, even as the repo rate remains focused on the domestic cycle.

Nervousness regarding RBI’s large forward book is unwarranted. Intervention using forwards, with a rising share of non-deliverable forwards (NDFs), has many rationales. First, since causality runs from the NDF market to domestic markets during global volatility, such intervention is more effective.

Second, NDF intervention does not

As India’s shock resilience and outperformance, including lower sensitivity to higher oil prices, become clearer, outflows should reverse

drain domestic liquidity unlike dollar sales in the spot market or settlement of domestic forwards. It helps insulate domestic liquidity from forex (FX) intervention. A domestic liquidity squeeze often accompanied past FX outflows, therefore markets fear it. But now, despite large outflows, durable liquidity remains in surplus.

Third, buying dollars forward does not reduce reserves immediately and may not even in the future. The forward book can be rolled over if needed. In NDF contracts only the net loss has to be paid. The cost maybe higher if the rupee is depreciating at that time. But so far the RBI has made large profits on its FX interventions. Therefore, the claim that the forward book has to be deducted in order to see what reserves really are is not entirely true. Derivatives are a more modern and economical way of intervening to reduce unwarranted risk perceptions. Their share in intervention has risen since 2013.

Fourth, the debate often worries about large new peaks in absolute numbers. A short forward book of above \$100 billion! But, because the size of relevant markets is growing, ratios are not materially larger. Intervention as a ratio of FX turnover this year is less than it was in 2014 or 2021.

FORWARD BOOK

A similar build-up of the forward book occurred during earlier global shocks, but was unwound or rolled over without problem. Already inflows under the FCNR(B) scheme have been used partly to close short NDF contracts maturing over the next three months. Returning inflows will be more than enough to unwind the forward book, to build up reserves and for the rupee to appreciate — because more than surplus dollars, appreciation just needs sentiment to change.

EMs tend to have self-fulfilling cycles of depreciation; advanced economy currency overshoots and then reverses.

Since inflation and risk are lower today in India, we could see nominal appreciation once sentiment improves. Past global shocks were temporary

and outflows always reversed. This period of volatility has, however, persisted since the end of 2024, longer than usual. The US tariffs were negative for India; FPI began chasing AI investments. War related oil shocks and other supply disruptions followed.

Global current account imbalances have increased to Covid-19 levels. The US deficit exceeds the large combined China and Euro Zone surplus. China’s surplus has increased to \$300 billion. Compared to many countries India’s deficit is tiny. Yet it has been punished inordinately by outflows. The lesson for the long term is to move to a surplus, with independence from any one kind of inflow for financing. There are many initiatives for this.

As India’s shock resilience and outperformance, including lower sensitivity to higher oil prices, become clearer, outflows should reverse. Advantages of natural and policy supported diversity are text-book plays to counter shocks.

Moreover, some of the shocks themselves are dissipating. The present 10 per cent US tariff on India is actually less than on its competitors and exports have anyway continued to do well. The AI play has begun to be questioned and Indian stock markets are set for a diversification payoff. The main benefit of AI is going to come from applications from which India is poised to benefit as it develops small language models using customisable open weight AI.

The world is going through unprecedented crises. The Indian policy response has sustained growth; monetary policy also is demonstrating that a good pilot can reach harbour even in stormy seas. For this it has to keep a steady course and also communicate ability and intent to nervous markets. US bond market yields rose, although a hold was widely expected, because the Fed Chair did not communicate inflation fighting intent alongside. Twice, when the governor hinted the rupee was undervalued, it appreciated.

The writer is President, TIES, and Professor Emeritus, IIGIR

How India’s contract labour framework is changing

It’s evolving into examining the circumstances in which core business activities may be performed through contract labour

Senthil Nathan B

The evolution of labour law rarely happens overnight. More often, it mirrors the changing needs of the economy. Over the past three decades, India’s approach to contract labour has undergone a quiet but fundamental transformation. What began as a law intended to regulate the engagement of contract labour is gradually evolving into a framework that examines the circumstances in which core business activities may legitimately be performed through contract labour.

The recent notification issued under the Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions (OSH) Code, 2020 illustrates that shift. Although the notification presently applies only to establishments under the Central Government’s jurisdiction, its significance extends beyond its immediate coverage. By prescribing a process to determine whether an activity constitutes a core activity, it offers an early indication of the direction in which India’s contract labour

framework is evolving.

When the Contract Labour (Regulation and Abolition) Act (CLRA Act) was enacted in 1970, India was predominantly an industrial economy. The concern before Parliament was not outsourcing as a business strategy.

The earlier framework required the Government to consider several factors, including whether the work was perennial and ordinarily performed by regular workmen. The OSH Code adopts a different starting point. For establishments covered by its contract labour provisions, it generally prohibits the engagement of contract labour in core activities, while recognising specified statutory exceptions where business realities justify such engagement. In many ways, the law has moved from regulating contract labour to examining the circumstances in which core business activities may legitimately be performed through contract labour.

The recent notification gives practical effect to that philosophy. It prescribes a structured process through which employers, contractors, workers, trade



LABOUR CODES. Redefining the relationship between outsourcing and contract labour REUTERS

unions and other stakeholders may seek a determination on whether an activity constitutes a core activity. Applications are examined by a designated authority before the appropriate Government takes a final decision after following the principles of natural justice.

The consequences, however, extend well beyond procedure. Once an activity is determined to be a core activity, organisations may need to revisit existing workforce arrangements unless one of the statutory exceptions applies. Decisions regarding outsourcing

through contract labour therefore become not merely questions of operational efficiency, but of legal sustainability. None of this suggests that the Labour Codes signal the end of workforce flexibility. The recognition of fixed term employment, together with the statutory exceptions permitting contract labour even in certain core activities, demonstrates that flexibility remains an important policy objective. The objective appears to be not the elimination of outsourcing, but the adoption of workforce models that are more consistent with the evolving philosophy of the law.

The significance of this shift therefore extends well beyond one notification. The CLRA Act regulated contract labour. The Labour Codes are beginning to redefine the relationship between outsourcing and contract labour.

For business leaders, that is no longer merely a labour law issue. It is increasingly becoming a question of corporate governance.

The writer is a senior Human Resources and Employee Relations leader

✉ LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Thrust on bank deposits

This refers to ‘The vanishing deposit base’ (August 1). In today’s rapidly evolving banking landscape, all banks — whether public or private — must remain relevant by adapting to the changing financial needs of their customers. However, in their pursuit of relevance, they should not compromise the very foundations of conventional banking — deposit mobilisation and prudent lending.

The article rightly highlights the importance of expanding bank deposits in order to enable banks to

lend at reasonable interest rates without resorting to high-cost sources of funding. Recommending mutual funds to one customer while encouraging another to remain in fixed deposits solely to achieve sales targets or protect deposit mobilisation would certainly dampen public trust.

S Lakshminarayanan

Ko-Puvanur, TN

HDFC Bank probe

The ongoing investigation into HDFC Bank regarding the alleged ₹45-crоре

differential interest paid to MSRDC under the appearance of vendor sponsorship raises critical systemic concerns regarding governance, regulatory compliance, and ethical standards in the private banking sector.

Two decades ago, HDFC Bank’s liability strategy was anchored in building a low-cost CASA deposit base while minimising reliance on high-cost fixed deposits. Today, amidst an elevated credit-deposit ratio, the bank appears to be aggressively chasing bulk liabilities

from corporates, state agencies, educational institutions, and temple trusts. Supplying indirect interest or compensatory payouts under the umbrella of sponsorships constitutes an explicit violation of RBI guidelines and an unethical business practice. Characterising such a breach merely as business overreach or outplay, rather than a fundamental failure of governance, reflects an unacceptable institutional dilution.

K Nagarajan

Andankovil Post, Karur, TN

Importing doctors

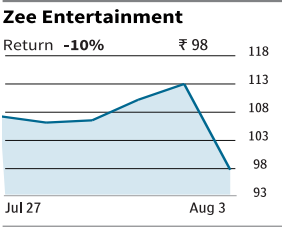
This refers to ‘The economics of medical education’ (August 3). Given that supply of expert doctors is less than the demand for them, the idea of importing doctors will definitely work for some time. However, it is imperative that the nation produces quality doctors and sound infrastructural facilities in the health sector in the long run. Dependence on other nations for goods and services is always dangerous.

S Ramkrishnasayee

Chennai

QUICKLY.

ZEEL tanks 15% on SEBI ban order, penalty



New Delhi: Shares of Zee Entertainment Enterprises Ltd tumbled 15 per cent on Monday after SEBI prohibited it from the securities market for two months and its Chairman Emeritus Subhash Chandra and MD & CEO Punit Goenka for one year over unauthorised pledge of the company's Hyderabad land to secure loans availed by promoter-linked Essel Group entities. The stock tanked 14.98 per cent to end at ₹98.15 on the BSE. The regulator imposed a total penalty of ₹1.48 crore on them. Individually, the regulator imposed penalties of ₹30 lakh on ZEEL, ₹60 lakh on Chandra and ₹58 lakh on Goenka. **PTI**

SEBI appoints Prasanta Mahapatra as ED

Mumbai: Markets regulator SEBI has appointed Prasanta Mahapatra as Executive Director. Based in Mumbai, he will oversee the Corporation Finance Investigation Department and the Recovery and Refund Department. Mahapatra was earlier Chief General Manager and has been with SEBI since April 1999. During his tenure, he has served across key departments including Market Regulation, Investigation, Enquiries and Adjudication, Market Intermediaries Regulation and Supervision, Corporation Finance, and Investment Management. He has also worked at SEBI's Eastern Regional Office in Kolkata and has been a member of several domestic policy and advisory committees. **OUR BUREAU**

Delayed justice in market violation cases makes a pittance of penalties

Suresh P Iyengar

The prolonged delay in closure of cases by the investigating agency, market regulators and judiciary make the penalties levied and other punishment pronounced appear less stringent compared to the crimes committed.

For instance, market regulator SEBI accepted the NSE's application to settle long-pending co-location and dark fibre cases for ₹1,491 crore.

PROBE BACKGROUND

Investigated by different investigating agencies for over two decades, the co-location case relates to allegations that certain brokers received preferential access to market data ahead of other participants.

The dark fibre matter pertains to allegations of preferential connectivity through the exchange's fibre network.

Sonam Chandwani, Managing Partner and founder, KS Legal & Associates, said there is a legitimate concern that the deterrent value of enforcement may be diluted

Muthoot Fin slumps 7% as brokerages flag margin pressure, post Q1 results

CAUTIOUS OULOOK. Most analysts remain bullish on the stock but see competition to impact business

Our Bureau
Bangaluru

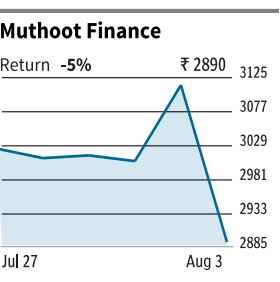
Muthoot Finance shares closed 7 per cent lower at ₹2,890.90 on the NSE on Monday after June quarter earnings triggered mixed reactions from brokerages, with concerns over margin compression outweighing healthy loan growth and a 25 per cent rise in profit. The stock, in fact, hit a low of ₹2,671 during the day. The gold loan lender reported a profit after tax of ₹2,550 crore in Q1-FY27, compared with ₹2,046 crore in the corresponding previous year quarter.

MIXED VIEWS
Global brokerage Bernstein maintained an 'Outperform'

rating with a target price of ₹4,500. The brokerage said Q1 was a mixed quarter, with healthy gold loan AUM growth overshadowed by a sharp 300 bps contraction in net interest margin as asset yields normalised from elevated levels seen in H2FY26. It said management expects yields to stabilise at 18-18.5 per cent, but selective rate reductions, a higher mix of lower-yielding loans and limited relief on funding costs could keep profitability under pressure. Bernstein added that while asset quality remains stable, the margin reset adds pressure to the current earnings growth trajectory. CLSA also maintained an 'Outperform' rating but cut target price to ₹4,000. It said Q1 profit missed its estimate



by 16 per cent, largely due to a net interest income miss driven by sharper-than-expected yield compression of about 300 bps. Morgan Stanley maintained an 'Overweight' rating with a target price of ₹3,705. It said net interest margin missed estimates, although the overall miss was contained by better loan growth. Further, consensus estimates were unusually



high given weak average gold prices q-o-q and elevated one-off yields in FY26. However, Jefferies downgraded the stock to 'Hold' and cut its target price to ₹3,300. The brokerage said Q1 profit after tax grew 25 per cent y-o-y to ₹25.5 billion but missed its estimate by 18 per cent as net interest margins fell sharply due to yield normalisation, rollover to lower rate slabs and price

MV Electrosystems leads mainboard IPO rush with 188.85x subscription, Juniper's gets 8 times

Our Bureau
Bangaluru

Mainboard IPOs attracted strong investor demand, with MV Electrosystems' public issue closing with an overall subscription of 188.85 times, while the ₹1,350 crore Juniper Green Energy IPO was subscribed 7.97 times. MV Electrosystems saw robust demand across investor categories. The qualified institutional buyers (QIB) portion was subscribed 90.47 times, the non-institutional investor (NII) category 374.58 times and

IPOs: Who bids					
	QIBs	Non-institutions	Retail	Employee	Total
MV Electrosystems	90.47	374.58	205.42	--	188.85
Juniper Green Energy	24.94	1.82	0.93	3.58	7.97

Source: Exchange

the retail investor portion 205.42 times. Juniper Green Energy's IPO was subscribed 24.94 times in the QIB category, 1.82 times in the NII category, 0.93 times in the retail category and 3.58 times in the employee portion. **MV ELECTROSYSTEMS** Ahead of its IPO, MV Electrosystems raised ₹130.5 crore from anchor investors.

The ₹290 crore IPO was priced at ₹400-425 a share and was entirely a fresh issue. The company said it will use the proceeds for business expansion and other corporate purposes. **JUNIPER GREEN** Ahead of its IPO, Gurugram-based Juniper Green Energy raised ₹539.4 crore from anchor investors, including Abu Dhabi Investment Au-

thority and Nippon India Mutual Fund. The IPO was priced at ₹214-225 a share and comprised entirely a fresh issue. The company plans to use ₹683.24 crore from the issue proceeds to repay or prepay certain borrowings. It will also invest ₹728.69 crore in its subsidiaries — Juniper Green Gamma One, Juniper Green Kite and Juniper Green Power Five — to help them repay or prepay outstanding loans. The remaining proceeds will be used for general corporate purposes. The shares are proposed to be listed on the BSE and the NSE on August 6.

BROKER'S CALL.

Axis Securities

GLOBAL HEALTH (HOLD)
Target: ₹1,495
CMP: ₹1,444.45
Medanta delivered a strong Q1FY27 performance, with revenue rising 26.5 per cent year on year to ₹1,304 crore. Growth was driven by a 21 per cent increase in occupied bed days and a 5.5 per cent rise in ARPOB to ₹70,244. Reported occupancy stood at 66 per cent, impacted by the ramp-up at the Noida hospital, while established hospitals continued to sustain healthy momentum. Total bed count increased 6.8 per cent to 2,851. EBITDA stood at ₹287 crore, with margins at 22 per cent flat year on year, primarily due to lower operating losses at the newly-commissioned Noida hospital. Noida reported an EBITDA loss of ₹5 crore, a significant improvement from the ₹23.6-crore loss reported in Q4FY26. The company added 51 beds during the quarter, taking the current capacity to 433 beds. Major empanelments across insurance companies, PSUs and corporates have been completed, with the management expecting the hospital to achieve EBITDA-break-even earlier than previously guided. The management's outlook remains focused on delivering sustainable, volume-led growth across its 3,350-bed expansion pipeline, with a target of restoring consolidated EBITDA margins to the 25-26 per cent range as newer assets mature. Operational performance is expected to be driven by high-acuity complex care, including oncology, robotic surgeries and organ transplants, along with a growing international patient base, supporting steady single-digit growth in ARPOB through a richer case mix rather than significant tariff hikes.

ICICI Securities

WESTLIFE FOOD (REDUCE)
Target: ₹450
CMP: ₹530.95
Westlife Foodworld reported consolidated revenue growth of 11.9 per cent year on year to ₹740 crore. Growth was driven by double-digit guest count growth across markets, aided by Everyday Value offerings. Performance was broad-based, with on-premise sales up 12 per cent and off-premise sales up 11 per cent, supported by continued strength in the McDelivery platform. Digital channels contributed about 74 per cent of revenue. Restaurant operating margin declined 128 bps to 18.6 per cent, primarily on account of input cost inflation. Despite these headwinds, EBITDA grew 10.8 per cent, while EBITDA margin contracted marginally (13 bps) to 12.9 per cent, supported by disciplined cost management and operating leverage. The management expects inflationary pressures to ease from current levels and continues to expect gross margins to remain above 67 per cent over the near-to-medium term. The company added five gross new restaurants in Q1FY27, while penetration of the McCafé format is 100 per cent and Drive-thru penetration is at 26 per cent of the eligible base. Westlife remains on track to add 60+ restaurants in FY27 and achieve its 580-630 store target by December 2027, supported by its disciplined expansion strategy. We largely maintain our estimates; modelling revenue/EBITDA CAGR of 11 per cent/18 per cent over FY26-28E. Maintain Reduce with a DCF-based unchanged target price of ₹450.

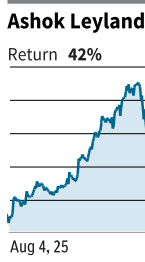
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TODAY'S PICK.

Ashok Leyland (₹174): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The short-term outlook is bullish for Ashok Leyland. The stock began the week on a strong note by surging over 4 per cent on Monday. This confirms an inverted head and shoulder pattern on the chart. The neckline support of this pattern is at ₹169. The 200-Day Moving Average (DMA) support is at ₹167. So, ₹169-₹167 will be the support zone which can limit the downside if the price dips from here. The share price can go up to ₹200 in the coming weeks. Traders can buy Ashok Leyland shares now at ₹174. Accumulate on dips at ₹170.



Keep the stop-loss at ₹162. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹177 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹181. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹183 and ₹188 when the price touches ₹187 and ₹191, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹194. Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

24660 » Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
24620	24580	24720	24800	Go long on dips at 24640 and 24590 with a stop-loss at 24560	
₹751 » HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
749	746	758	764	Go long on a bounce from 749 with a stop-loss at 747	
₹1170 » Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1155	1135	1190	1220	Go long only above 1190. Keep the stop-loss at 1185	
₹286 » ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
284	280	290	293	Wait for dips. Go long at 285. Keep the stop-loss at 283	
₹241 » ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
239	236	243	246	Take fresh longs only above 243. Keep the stop-loss at 242	
₹1309 » Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1300	1285	1318	1345	Go long on dips at 1303. Stop-loss can be kept at 1295	
₹1036 » SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1030	1020	1050	1070	Wait for dips. Go long at 1032 with a stop-loss at 1025	
₹2451 » TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2420	2380	2500	2545	Wait for dips. Go long at 2425. Stop-loss can be placed at 2410	

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

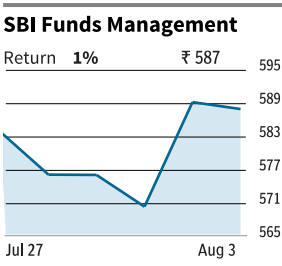
Hindenburg-linked FPIs to file plea afresh with SAT

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities Appellate Tribunal (SAT) on Monday allowed five offshore funds to withdraw their appeals challenging the Securities and Exchange Board of India's adjudication process, with liberty to file fresh petitions incorporating amendments. The appeals were filed by LTS Investment Fund Ltd, Cresta Fund, Asia Investment Corporation (Mauritius), APMS Investment Fund and Albula Investment Fund, which had challenged the manner in which SEBI initiated adjudication proceedings against them.

PROCEDURAL ISSUE
During the hearing, counsel for the funds sought permission to withdraw the existing petitions and refile them with certain amendments. The tribunal accordingly dis-

posed of the appeals as withdrawn. The funds had earlier argued that SEBI's adjudicating officer failed to comply with Rule 4(3) of the SEBI (Procedure for Holding Inquiry and Imposing Penalties by Adjudicating Officer) Rules. They said that after receiving replies to the show-cause notices, the adjudicating officer was required to form and communicate a reasoned opinion on whether proceedings should continue before calling them for a personal hearing. The five offshore funds were among entities named in Hindenburg Research's January 2023 report on the Adani Group. While SEBI in September 2025 closed proceedings against Adani Group companies, Chairman Gautam Adani and related entities after finding no violations of securities regulations, adjudication proceedings involving certain offshore funds have continued separately.



up 11 per cent at ₹12.51 lakh crore (₹9.14 lakh crore). The average quarterly equity AUM increased 12 per cent to ₹5.90 lakh crore (₹5.24 lakh crore) while that of debt and liquid funds were up at ₹1.61 lakh crore (₹1.60 lakh crore) and ₹1.07 lakh crore (₹93,500 crore). Inflows through systematic investment plan was up

14 per cent at ₹4,000 crore year-on-year.

SIP FLOWS
However on a sequential basis it was down two per cent. The SIP AUM increased 15 per cent at ₹2.06 lakh crore (₹1.79 lakh crore). Unique customers was up 12 per cent at 1.82 crore. Passive quarterly average AUM increased 12 per cent y-on-y to ₹4 lakh crore. Alternate AUM (comprising AIF, PMS, Advisory and Off-shore funds) stood at ₹16.5 lakh crore for the quarter ended June. The fund house has total reserves of ₹6,498 crore as of quarter-end. The stock was down marginally at ₹588 on Monday.

Nifty 50 Movers					▲ 390.70 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN%	
ICICI Bank	1460.00	38.51	17.53	9.23	
Infosys	1180.00	38.25	15.79	3.65	
Axis Bank	1272.00	26.67	14.16	3.22	
TCS	2473.70	24.12	17.88	2.23	
L&T	4025.00	22.02	28.22	4.16	
Reliance Ind	1319.00	16.53	20.25	7.86	
HDFC Bank	753.00	16.23	14.05	10.17	
State Bank	1045.00	15.90	11.13	3.81	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1090.20	13.31	22.66	1.35	
Greaves Ind	3350.00	13.33	21.54	1.08	
Eternal Ltd	310.50	12.72	69.02	1.98	
ITC	287.00	12.64	17.11	2.44	
Kotak Bank	397.50	11.58	19.48	2.58	
Int'l Globeavi	5400.00	11.33	0.00	1.08	
Titan	5000.00	11.26	87.48	1.82	
Bajaj Finserv	2096.00	8.46	17.06	1.07	
Bajaj Auto	11856.00	8.12	28.68	1.16	
Hind Unilever	2138.00	7.11	47.87	1.67	
HCL Tech	1377.00	6.93	21.43	1.23	
Bajaj Finance	1153.00	6.91	34.77	2.78	
Eicher Motors	8050.00	6.52	38.28	0.98	
Hindalco	994.90	6.47	16.70	1.27	
Asian Paints	620.00	3.83	66.89	0.64	
M&M	3428.60	5.87	21.06	2.70	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	263.00	4.69	84.04	0.76	
JSW Steel	1292.30	4.57	11.29	1.07	
Tata Motors PV	349.30	4.36	4288.04	0.64	
Dr Reddys Lab	1180.00	4.25	30.94	0.63	
UltraTech Cement	12654.00	3.90	41.44	1.26	
Tata Consumer/Product	1110.00	3.80	55.72	1.12	
NTPC	350.90	3.78	12.01	1.47	
Adani Enter	3068.00	3.69	53.13	0.78	
Bharat Elec	392.15	3.37	46.63	1.24	
SBI Life	1915.00	3.24	73.86	0.76	
Trent Ltd.	3050.00	3.21	94.49	0.90	
Nestle India	15642.50	3.20	77.12	0.97	
Wipro	188.66	2.96	14.06	0.45	
PowerGrid Corp	287.00	2.72	16.76	1.15	
Tata Steel	191.00	2.37	21.17	1.39	
HDFC Life	553.10	1.98	60.43	0.52	
Coal India	416.00	0.97	8.25	0.08	
Adani Ports	1705.00	0.73	29.87	0.11	
Max Healthcare	1100.40	0.31	74.25	0.72	
Cipla	1474.40	0.15	35.49	0.73	
Tech Mahindra	1649.00	-0.32	31.30	0.92	
ONGC	242.00	-0.45	6.11	0.83	
Bharti Airtel	1970.50	-1.00	35.50	5.29	
Maruti Suzuki	14150.00	-2.39	30.31	1.63	
Apollo Hosp	8630.00	-3.08	63.34	1.02	
Sun Pharma	1963.50	-6.25	40.94	1.83	
Pts: Impact on index movement					
Nifty Next 50 Movers					▲ 957.40 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN%	
Divis Lab	8585.00	195.37	88.75	4.25	
Tata Motors Cv	452.50	95.29	55.03	3.68	
LtImidtree	4690.00	88.50	26.77	1.70	
Bpyl	2329.95	60.07	8.36	2.60	
Samarvadmotheresoninternatl	155.01	54.69	40.04	2.67	
Tvs Motor Cmp .	4389.00	51.81	57.90	4.02	
Abb India	7601.00	48.27	101.93	1.55	
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1888.20	48.15	27.99	1.38	
Avenuesuper	4015.00	44.02	85.65	2.52	
Britannia Ind	5531.00	39.20	52.51	2.54	
Indian Oilcorp	143.70	38.33	4.65	2.09	
Shree Cement	27000.00	36.73	55.71	1.41	
Siemens	3900.00	35.96	90.61	1.34	
Indian Hotels Co .	752.00	34.32	46.36	2.57	
Bajaj Holdings	11599.00	32.21	13.19	1.96	
Adani Power .	213.65	28.22	28.35	3.45	
Pidlind	1642.50	28.01	67.66	1.97	
Bank Of Baroda	247.25	25.07	6.95	1.79	

QUICKLY.

Windfall tax on petrol, diesel, ATF exports raised



India has raised windfall taxes on exports of diesel and aviation fuel as global oil prices continue to remain volatile over the Iran conflict, according to a government order on Monday. The export duty on petrol has been increased to ₹3.5 per litre from ₹2.5 to ensure domestic supply effective from Monday, the order said. The total duty on diesel exports has been raised to ₹25.5 per litre through two tax levies from ₹15.5 a fortnight ago. The tax on aviation fuel duty has been set at ₹22 per litre up from ₹14.5 from Monday. REUTERS

RBI appoints Monisha Chakraborty as ED

Mumbai: The Reserve Bank of India has appointed Monisha Chakraborty as Executive Director (ED), who will oversee the departments of foreign exchange and financial markets regulation. Prior to being promoted as ED, she was serving as Chief General Manager-in-Charge in the Department of Supervision. PTI

FM moves Bill on presenting bank records as evidence in courts

LEGAL OVERHAUL. Bankers’ Books Evidence Bill, 2026 to replace the 1891 Act with a tech-neutral framework

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday introduced a Bill to replace a 125-year-old law with one that seeks to preserve access to banking evidence, while protecting banks from unnecessary legal proceedings, shifting the emphasis to better-targeted judicial oversight, rather than unrestricted access to banking records.

According to officials, the government has undertaken the review and modernisation of legacy legislation. The Bankers’ Books Evidence Act, 1891, is one such legislation. Enacted in the era of paper-based banking, it facilitated the use of certified copies of bank records as evidence in legal proceedings. However, “with the advent of digital banking and electronic record-keeping, the existing legal framework no longer adequately reflects contemporary banking practices,” an official said. The Bankers’ Books Evidence Bill, 2026, seeks to repeal and replace the Bankers’



MAKING A POINT. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman speaking in the Lok Sabha during the Monsoon Session of Parliament in New Delhi on Monday PTI

Books Evidence Act, 1891. It provides for a technology-neutral legal framework for bankers’ books, recognises electronic and digital banking records, standardises the certification process, facilitates the admissibility of electronic banking records, permits authentication through manual, digital and electronic signatures, strengthens the statutory protection available to bank officers where the bank is not

a party to the proceedings by requiring the court to record the existence of a special cause before summoning them,

DIGITAL SHIFT

The Bill comes against the backdrop of the rapid expansion of digital banking and the sharp rise in cyber-enabled financial frauds, including online scams and so-called “digital arrest” cases. It seeks to modernise the

legal framework governing banking evidence to reflect the realities of electronic record-keeping and digital financial transactions.

A key feature of the proposed law is the introduction of the concept of “special cause”, under which a court may, by a written order, compel a bank officer to produce bankers’ books or appear as a witness in proceedings where the bank itself is not a party.

The provision raises the threshold for summoning bank officials, ensuring they are not routinely drawn into litigation merely because they hold customer records.

The Bill defines “special cause” to include circumstances where the accuracy or authenticity of an entry in the bankers’ books is in doubt, where an event suggests that the bank’s normal record-keeping process has been disrupted, or where the bank has failed to comply with a legal order.

In other words, courts will continue to have access to banking records in genuine cases, but only after recording specific reasons for doing so.

The legislation also significantly expands the definition of “bankers’ books” to include records maintained in physical, electronic, digital, virtual, cloud-based or any other form, creating a technology-neutral legal framework that can accommodate future advances in banking.

ELECTRONIC FORM

To facilitate the use of electronic evidence, the Bill provides for standardised certification formats, permits authentication through manual, digital or electronic signatures, and expressly recognises the admissibility of electronic banking records. Such records may be produced before courts in either physical or electronic form.

Another enabling provision empowers the Central Government to extend the applicability of the legislation to other entities or classes of entities operating in the financial sector, subject to prescribed conditions. This gives the law flexibility to cover new categories of regulated financial institutions as the sector evolves.

Govt moots tax relief for diamond trade and offshore investment funds

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The government has proposed tax relief for foreign entities engaged in the rough diamond trade and relaxed eligibility norms for offshore investment funds managed from India under the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, which is expected to be introduced in Parliament on Tuesday.

The Bill, reviewed by *businessline*, amends the Income Tax Act, 2025, the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, and the Finance Act, 2026. It also seeks to repeal the Income-Tax (Amendment) Ordinance, 2026, which had provided tax exemptions on interest income and capital gains from government securities earned by foreign investors.

The Bill proposes a new tax exemption for eligible foreign entities engaged in the rough diamond trade, covering income from sales undertaken through notified special zones in India.

The exemption, available until March 31, 2041, and subject to prescribed reporting requirements, is intended to provide long-term tax certainty to global diamond

mining companies, sight-holders, brokers, aggregators and auction entities. The legislation also introduces a statutory definition of “rough diamond”, providing greater clarity for tax administration.

OFFSHORE FUNDS

The proposed legislation also relaxes the eligibility conditions for Eligible Investment Funds managed from India to claim tax exemption on global income.

Under the amendments, offshore funds will no longer have to satisfy conditions such as maintaining a minimum of 25 investors, limiting a single investor’s participation to 10 per cent, or restricting investments in a single entity to 25 per cent of the corpus. According to tax experts, the changes are aimed at making India a more attractive destination for global fund managers.

“These proposed changes are expected to significantly enhance the attractiveness of India’s onshore fund management ecosystem for offshore funds and facilitate greater relocation of offshore fund management activities to India,” said Abheet Sachdeva, Partner – M&A Tax, Nangia Global.

House panel supports more power to NFRA

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

A parliamentary panel has supported the government’s move to further empower the National Financial Reporting Authority (NFRA) but with certain checks. At the same time, it also suggested that buyback of equity shares in any financial year shall not exceed 25 per cent of its total paid-up equity capital in that financial year.

Also, it recommended that the Central government may notify a comprehensive framework to facilitate the conversion of specified trusts into limited liability partnerships. All these 169 recommendations are part of a report submitted to Parliament by the Joint Committee on the Corporate Laws (Amendment) Bill.

Based on the report, the government is expected to rework the Bill, get Cabinet approval and then move the Bill for consideration and passage.

EXPANDED POWERS

In its report, the committee felt that the expanded powers for registration, investigation, delegated regulation-making powers and the proposed body corporate status may broaden NFRA’s role beyond its original over-

KEY RECOMMENDATIONS

- Insertion of new section to provide subordinate rule-making power for handling personal data in compliance with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023
- Insertion of new chapter to enable seamless re-domiciliation of foreign companies to IFSC without requiring winding-up in their home jurisdiction
- Replacing fine, which may extend to ₹1 lakh, with fixed penalty amount of ₹50,000 in cases where companies default in compliance with provisions in line with the objective of decriminalisation and rationalisation exercise
- Reducing the minimum age for appointment as Managing Director, Whole-time Director or Manager from 21 years to 18 years and raising the maximum age from 70 years to 75 years



sight function. “In the considered opinion of the committee, this may result in overlap with the statutory functions of ICAI (Institute of Chartered Accounts of India) leading to regulatory duplication, institutional fragmentation, increased compliance burden, and uncertainty regarding jurisdictional boundaries,” it said.

Accordingly, it recommended the Ministry take steps to ensure that amendments to the Companies Act not dilute or override the statutory autonomy granted to ICAI under the Chartered Accountants Act, 1949.

Instead, “the legislative framework must allow a harmonious coexistence where NFRA’s role under the Companies Act remains strictly focused on corporate financial oversight, leaving professional development, standard-drafting foundations, and primary domain matters to the statutory purview of ICAI,” it said.

BUYBACK LIMITS

On this issue, the committee took cognizance of lack of requisite clarity on the permissible buy-back limits of 25 per cent on paid-up capital, free reserves and on

equity shares as the case may be. There is also need to clarify the reckoning of year for determining two buy backs and the computation of six months gap between the previous and following buy back.

Accordingly, it suggested modification to ensure buy-back of equity shares in any financial year shall not exceed 25 per cent of its total paid-up equity capital in that financial year. According to the Committee, where a specified trust operates or maintains multiple schemes, or such other structure which is not already covered under this Schedule, a framework may be provided for conversion of such trust into a limited liability partnership, subject to such conditions, and procedure, as may be prescribed, suggested the committee.

“The Central government may notify a comprehensive framework to facilitate the conversion of specified trusts into limited liability partnerships, including provisions relating to taxation, capital gains, stamp duty, transfer and vesting of assets and liabilities, filing and compliance requirements, continuation of rights and obligations, and other consequential or incidental matters arising from such conversion,” it said.

Ethanol blending: Team Bharat to meet Oil Ministry officials this week

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Team Bharat said that it has been invited by the Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas for a follow-up meeting within the next 3-4 days to continue discussions on key issues concerning consumer choice, fuel pricing, and the implementation of the Ethanol 20 (E20) fuel policy.

Team Bharat, which is led by political analyst Tehseen Poonawalla, is protesting against what it claims is a rushed implementation of the ethanol blended petrol (EBP) programme under which 20 per cent ethanol is blended with 80 per cent petrol.

During the upcoming meeting, Team Bharat will continue to present the concerns received from vehicle owners and consumers while reiterating its key recommendations relating to consumer choice, affordability, transparency and the practical implementation of the E20 policy, it added.

Team Bharat believes that meaningful public policy is strengthened through continuous dialogue, evidence-based discussions and active citizen participation.

PSU OMCs’ average LPG cylinder refill time falls in July, but still above Jan-Feb

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

During the West Asia conflict, the PSU oil marketing companies (OMCs) implemented strict system-controls to clear long-pending bookings while adhering to the First In First Out (FIFO) principle bringing down the high average LPG cylinder refill time during March-June 2026, but it still trails January-February levels.

Minister of State for Petroleum & Natural Gas Suresh Gopi, in a written response in the Rajya Sabha, emphasised that the steps taken by the government and the PSU oil marketing companies helped reduce the average refill delivery time across the country from 4.33 days on June 1, 2026 to 2.15 days on July 27, 2026.

REFILL TIME

Data shared by the Minister showed that average domestic liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) cylinder refill time for oil marketing companies stood at 1.57 days and 1.32 days during January and February 2026.

This average time rose to 3.79 days in March 2026 rising further to 5.54 days in April and 5.21 days in May,

OMCs' average domestic LPG cylinder delivery backlog (days)			
2026	Net bookings	Refills delivered	Monthly average backlog (days)
January	18,04,68,987	18,11,31,213	1.38
February	16,58,45,314	16,83,83,111	1.32
March	18,18,52,977	15,69,93,302	3.79
April	12,61,12,810	13,74,03,847	5.54
May	13,06,52,204	13,38,58,279	5.21
June	12,79,02,102	13,65,15,828	3.68

Source: Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas, Rajya Sabha

before cooling down to 3.68 in June and then to 2.15 days as of July 27.

Prior to the outbreak of conflict in West Asia in February 2026, India used to import about 60 per cent of its LPG consumption, out of which about 90 per cent was transiting through the Strait of Hormuz (SoH). With its closure, supplies of imported LPG were severely constrained, Gopi pointed out.

WEST ASIA CONFLICT

The government took a series of proactive measures to ensure stability in LPG supplies post the outbreak of the conflict.

In order to prioritise supply in the domestic LPG sector, several temporary demand management measures were also implemented such as implementation of an inter-refill gap of

25 days for urban areas and 45 days for rural areas and rationalizing stock management at bottling plants, he added.

Besides, oil marketing companies implemented system-controls to ensure that their distributors clear long-pending bookings while adhering to the FIFO principle.

This prevented customers facing prolonged delay and ensured timely and equitable delivery of LPG refill to maximum genuine consumers, the Minister said.

The measures also enabled oil marketing companies to identify distributors with excessive pendency and take corrective action, thereby improving delivery efficiency and ensuring more equitable and timely supply of LPG refills to genuine consumers, he added.

Govt urged to examine feasibility of permitting CSR contributions in kind

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

A Parliamentary panel has recommended to the government to examine the feasibility of permitting CSR contributions in kind through an appropriate statutory or regulatory framework. It supported increasing the threshold of profit to ₹10 crore for CSR, which would benefit Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME).

At present, the Companies Act says that a company having net worth of ₹500 crore or more or turnover of ₹1,000 crore or more or a net profit of ₹5 crore or more in the immediately preceding financial years needs to spend 2 per cent of its profit on Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR).

The Corporate Laws (Amendment) Bill proposed raising the threshold for applicability of CSR to ₹10 crore.

Also, it proposed additional time for transfer of unspent CSR amounts to the designated account, enhancing the threshold for consti-



tution of the CSR Committee, and enabling exemption of such class or classes of companies as may be prescribed.

In its report, the Joint Committee, while favouring the higher threshold, was of the considered view that recognising in-kind contributions, where appropriately regulated, has the potential to enhance the effectiveness, flexibility and impact of CSR initiatives by enabling companies to leverage their core competencies and resources for public benefit.

At the same time, the committee recognises that such a framework must adequately address concerns relating to objective valuation, transparency, auditability and accountability.

It also noted that the pro-

posal of the National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA) to treat the free-of-cost supply of products for disaster relief as eligible CSR expenditure is presently under consideration and that valuation principles under the GST framework have been suggested for determining the value of such contributions.

The Committee, therefore, “recommend that the Government examine the feasibility of permitting CSR contributions in kind through an appropriate statutory or regulatory framework, incorporating robust safeguards, including objective valuation norms, independent verification, appropriate disclosure and reporting requirements, and effective monitoring mechanisms, so as to prevent misuse or overvaluation while ensuring that the objectives and integrity of the CSR framework are fully preserved.”

UNUTILISED FUNDS

It agreed that CSR funds should not be utilised through any implementing

agency, including organisations, trusts, societies, non-governmental organisations and Section 8 companies.

It was of the view that any CSR contribution made to an entity included in a duly notified negative list should not qualify as CSR expenditure for the purposes of compliance.

Further it recommended that the criteria for inclusion of any entity in such a negative list should be objective, transparent and based solely on statutory provisions or orders passed by a competent authority, to ensure certainty, fairness and uniform application.

It also recommended that the restriction should operate only for the period and subject to the conditions specified in the relevant notification, and that an appropriate statutory mechanism be provided for removal of an entity from the negative list upon the cessation of the grounds that led to its inclusion. Accordingly, it suggested change in the bill prescribing a negative list of entities ineligible to receive CSR contributions.

‘Ethanol blending in petrol can help India save ₹38,000 crore annually’

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The ethanol blended petrol (EBP) programme, under which 80 per cent petrol and 20 per cent ethanol is blended, can help reduce India’s crude oil import bill by \$4 billion, or around ₹38,000 crore on an annual basis.

For comparison, India spent \$137 billion and \$122 billion during FY25 and FY26, respectively, in purchasing crude oil.

Minister of State for Petroleum & Natural Gas Suresh Gopi, in a written response in the Rajya Sabha, said that as per the Roadmap for Ethanol Blending in India 2020-25, a successful E20 programme can save the country about \$4 billion per annum.

The Minister emphasised that the EBP Programme has been implemented through a phased, scientifically validated and consultative process involving NITI Aayog, automobile manufacturers, oil marketing companies, Automotive Research Asso-



MoS Suresh Gopi

ciation of India, Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers, Indian Institute of Petroleum and other technical institutions.

In India, the EBP Programme commenced with a pilot in 2001. The E15+ blended petrol has been in widespread use across the country for over three-and-a-half years and E19-E20 fuel for over two-and-a-half years, Gopi added.

More than 20 crore two-wheelers and over 3 crore petrol cars have been operating on these blends without any verified evidence of widespread engine failure or abnormal wear attributable to E20 fuel, the Minister said.

**TELANGANA POWER GENERATION CORPORATION LIMITED**
VIDYUT SOUDHA - HYDERABAD – 82.
T.No.e-01/CE/SE-III/EME-05/TPC/TGGENCO/2026-27

YTPS - Design, engineering, procurement, material selection, manufacturing, inspection at vendor / sub vendors works before dispatch, packing, shipping, delivery at site for indigenous equipment, insurance, unloading, handling and storage at site, assembly, erection, testing, commissioning, successful performance guarantee, handing over of the Substation, Power supply distribution system, illumination and street lighting system, providing Diesel Generator sets for extending alternate power supply at various locations in YTPS colony town ship including residential and non-residential complexes with all accessories, Mandatory Spares, Tools & Tackles for CHP area at Yadadri Thermal Power Station, Veerlapealem (V), Dameracherla (Mdl), Nalagonda Dist. Value of the works **₹34,68,96,079/-** Schedule Extended upto: **06.08.2026 at 16:00 Hrs.**
T.No.e-11/CE/Civil/Thermal/TGGENCO/2026-27

YTPS – Providing plantation in the area between Ash Pond and Tungapadu vagu (Part-I) on the D/S of Ash pond at Yadadri Thermal Power Station Veerlapealem (V), Dameracherla (Mdl), Nalagonda Dist. Value of the works: **₹2,39,96,000/-** Schedule Extended upto: **11.08.2026 at 17:00 Hrs.**
T.No.e-14/CE/Civil/Thermal/TGGENCO-2026-27

YTPS – Maintenance of all railway lines of YTPS railway siding from takeoff point at Janpand end/Vishnupuram end to Marshalling yard end point completely from ETKM of 47.05 km from 01.08.2026 or from the actual date of commencement to 31.03.2027 at Yadadri Thermal Power Station Veerlapealem (V), Dameracherla (Mdl), Nalagonda Dist. Value of the works: **₹1,10,65,666/-** Schedule Extended upto: **04.08.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.**
T.No.e-08/CE/Civil/Hydel/GS/TGGENCO/2026-27

NSHES – Construction of one Block (Ground + First Floor) of School Building consisting five class rooms, Science Lab, Library and Sports Room including Electrification at AMPRPLUS/Puttamangudi under Corporate Social Responsibility at Nagarjunasagar Power House, Nalagonda Dist. Value of the works: **₹2,04,45,073/-** Schedule Extended upto: **12.08.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.**
T.No.e-15/CE/Civil/Thermal/TGGENCO/2026-27

BTPS – Construction of Compound walls for School, Hospital and storage shed for gas godown in Township area at Bhadradi Thermal Power Station, Manuguru, Bhadradi Kothagudem Dist.- Value of the works: **₹96,52,029/-** Scheduled Open & Closing Date: **01.08.2026 at 17:00 Hrs. & 17.08.2026 at 17:00 Hrs.**
T.No.e-16/CE/Q&M/KTPS-V&V/BM-V/P31/TGGENCO/2026-27

KTPS-V&V – Procurement of Screw Conveyor Assemblies (DE and NDE) for Ball Tube Mills BBD 4772 in Unit- 09 & 10 at Kothagudem Thermal Power Station Stage-V Paloncha, Bhadradi Kothagudem Dist. Value of the works **₹31,43,994/-** Scheduled Open & Closing Date: **05.08.2026 at 10:00 Hrs. & 25.08.2026 at 15:30 Hrs.**
T.No.e-169/CE/Q&M/KTPS-VII/P42/Pur/TGGENCO/2026-27

KTPS-VII – Procurement of 12 Ton Hydraulic Mobile Crane at Kothagudem Thermal Power Station Stage-VII, Paloncha, Bhadradi Kothagudem Dist. Value of the works: **₹28,00,000/-** Scheduled Open & Closing Date: **22.07.2026 at 16:00 Hrs 12.08.2026 at 15:30 Hrs.**
T.No.e-53/CEG/SEG-III/EME-VII/KTPP/TGGENCO/2026-27

KTPP – Remnant Life Assessment (RLA) & Condition Assessment (CA) of Boiler and its Auxiliaries as per Indian Boiler Regulations 1950, Unit-1 at Kakatiya Thermal Power Project, Chelur(V), Channur(M) Jayashankar Bhupallipally Dist. Value of the works: **₹9,00,000/-** Scheduled Open & Closing Date: **30.07.2026 at 17:00 Hrs. & 20.08.2026 at 11:00 Hrs.**
For further Details: www.tggenco.com and www.tender.telangana.gov.in
DIPR R.O.No.384-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADV7/2026-27 Dt:03-08-2026

After SEBI order, Zee’s ₹3,143 crore fundraise may hinge on SAT relief

LEGAL HURDLE. Shareholder approval alone may not be enough to complete preferential issue in ban period

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

Zee Entertainment’s ₹3,143-crore promoter fundraise may not be able to proceed until the company secures legal relief from the Securities Appellate Tribunal (SAT) or the expiry of SEBI’s two-month market access ban, with the company expected to go to the tribunal soon.

The timing is difficult for the company. On the same day that the shareholders cleared the warrant issue to a promoter group entity, SEBI passed its final order in the unauthorised pledge of immovable property case, barring ZEEL from accessing the securities market for two months and restraining promoter Subhash Chandra and Managing Director Punit Goenka from dealing in securities for a year. The order creates a regulatory bar on



RELIEF ROUTE. The practical effect would be to put the issue on hold unless Zee secures relief from SAT or another forum

the transaction, and the company cannot assume that corporate approval is enough to move ahead, said Alay Razvi, Managing Partner at Accord Juris.

“SEBI’s order creates a direct legal overlay on Zee’s proposed fund raise. The regulator has restrained the company from accessing the securities market for a

defined period and has barred the promoters from dealing in securities. That means, on the face of the order, the company cannot proceed with issuance or allotment of warrants or other securities while the restraint is in force,” Razvi said.

Hardeep Sachdeva, Senior Partner at AZB & Partners, said, “The legal effect of

SEBI’s order will ultimately depend on the precise wording of its operative directions and the stage at which the proposed preferential issue currently stands. Shareholder approval, by itself, does not grant an unconditional right to complete a capital raise. Every subsequent step must continue to comply with the Companies Act, the SEBI (ICDR) Regulations and any specific restrictions imposed by SEBI.”

“What is affected is the ability to act upon that approval during the restraint period, Tushar Agarwal,” Founder and Managing Partner at CLAP Juris, Advocates & Solicitors, said.

‘ENABLING INSTRUMENT’
“A shareholder resolution is an enabling instrument; it is not a regulatory passport. The corporate approval may continue to exist, but its im-

plementation remains subject to securities-law restraints operating on the issuer at the time of allotment, he said.

Anshul Verma, Partner at SKV Law Offices, said a precedent can be found in a recent Droneacharya Aerial Innovations vs SEBI case appealed in SAT.

A company under a regulatory market debarment was still permitted to proceed with a preferential share issue, but only because the tribunal specifically granted that relief while an appeal against the debarment was pending. The debarment itself didn’t get waived, the company simply obtained a carved-out exception for that one transaction, he said.

The practical effect would be to put the issue on hold unless Zee secures relief from SAT or another forum, lawyers said.

Crude oil prices drop after Trump cancels attack on Iran

Reuters
London

Crude oil prices fell more than \$4 a barrel on Monday after US President Donald Trump held off a fresh attack on Iran as he sought a quick deal that would halt Tehran’s nuclear ambitions and reopen the Strait of Hormuz.

Brent crude futures fell

\$4.23, or 4.8 per cent, to \$83.70 by 1011 GMT, having retraced some losses from a three-week low hit earlier in the session. US West Texas Intermediate crude was at \$79.60 a barrel, down \$5.07, or 6 per cent. Both benchmarks marked their biggest daily falls in absolute and percentage terms since last Monday. Both contracts had

jumped more than 20 per cent last month after fighting between the US and Iran resumed and attacks on several tankers around Oman heightened security concerns, deterring shippers from entering the Gulf to load oil.

In a sign of de-escalation, Trump said late on Saturday on his Truth Social platform that Iran and other West

Asian countries had asked for time to complete a deal that would lead to “the Immediate, Complete and Total” reopening of the Strait and “an end to Iran’s nuclear threat”. Details remain unclear.

CAN A DEAL HAPPEN?
“The bigger focus is whether this week turns into a rinse and repeat of last week —

with hopes of a deal collapsing as Iran digs in its heels and continues to leverage its control over the Strait,” IG market analyst Tony Sycamore said. Two tankers laden with Saudi oil crossed the Bab el-Mandeb Strait over the weekend but traffic both in the Strait of Hormuz and Bab el-Mandeb slowed, shipping data showed.

Amid Opposition protests, Rajya Sabha passes Bill to tackle payment delays faced by MSMEs

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The Rajya Sabha on Monday passed a Bill that seeks to tackle the issue of delayed payments to MSMEs by prescribing timelines to ensure faster adjudication of disputes, provide recovery of the settlement agreement, and address their liquidity issues, even as Opposition members continued to disrupt the House.

The Upper House was adjourned for the day soon after the passage of the Micro Small and Medium Enterprises (Amendment) Bill, 2026, that seeks to empower courts to order payment of at least 50 per cent of the awarded amount to MSME suppliers, if the application to set aside an order is



Union MSME Minister
Jitan Ram Manjhi ANI

pending for more than six months.

Members of the Opposition kept raising slogans throughout the discussion of the Bill and later during its passage by voice vote. They were demanding the presence of Home Minister Amit Shah to answer questions on police action against students protesting the NEET exam paper leak and kept

shouting slogans like “we want justice”.

Replying to the discussion on the Bill, Union Minister for MSME Jitan Ram Manjhi outlined the advantages of the proposed legislation for the sector and various sections of society, and expressed dismay at the loud protests by Opposition members.

“We expected our opposition allies to support, co-operate, and pass this bill, but today they are opposing ... I am surprised, but despite this, I propose before the House that this Bill be passed by amending the 2006 Act,” said the Minister.

The Bill seeks to address the current challenges faced by the MSME sector by improving the administrative structure and facilitating payment mechanisms, he said. “Its objective is to bal-

ance the interests of all concerned parties while maintaining constitutional principles and the interests of businesses,” Manjhi said, reassuring the House that the government is committed to the development of the MSME sector.

He described the MSME sector as the backbone of the economy, which contributes significantly to the country’s manufacturing and exports.

He outlined that MSMEs contribute 31 per cent to India’s GDP, 36 per cent to the country’s manufacturing and 41 per cent to its exports.

“The outstanding credit disbursed to MSMEs, which stood at ₹10 lakh crore in 2014-15, has today increased to over ₹38.35 lakh crore, denoting that the credit flow to MSMEs is rising steadily,” the Minister told the House.

Our Bureau
Chennai

LIC Mutual Fund, the asset management company partially owned by the public sector insurer Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC), is gearing up to launch a Specialised Investment Fund (SIF) with a target corpus of ₹500 crore.

A Specialised Investment Fund is an investment category that requires a minimum investment of ₹10 lakh. It provides exposure to long-short positions and unhedged derivatives, and combines traditional mutual funds with Portfolio Management Services.

Speaking at the launch of the company’s new office here on Monday, RK Jha, MD and CEO of LIC Mutual Fund, stated that the company is awaiting regulatory approval for the SIF, with a launch planned for October, subject to market conditions.

AUM SURGE

He said that while LIC Mutual Fund was not a ‘serious player’ earlier, in the past three years, the fund house has seen exponential growth

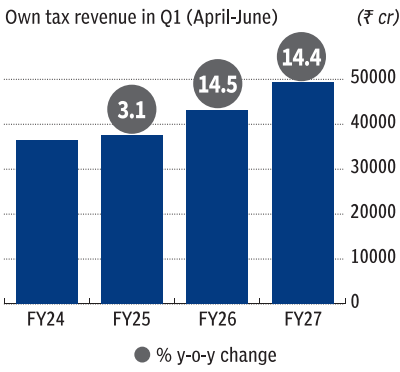
VISUALLY.

Compiled by **Sindhu Hariharan, Yashaswani Chauhan** | Graphic **KS Gunasekar**

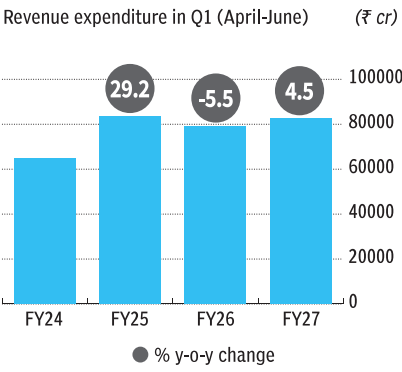
TN finances under new government

The newly elected Tamilaga Vetri Kazhagam (TVK) government of Tamil Nadu is still testing the water and all eyes are on its first Budget, which is set to be presented this Wednesday. In Q1 of FY27, the first quarter under the regime (the party took over in early May), own tax revenue collections have continued to grow at a strong pace but revenue expenses have begun creeping higher. Spending on capex has been 20 per cent lower compared to the same quarter last fiscal, while debt has continued to grow. This comes at a time when the State has constituted an expert committee under eminent economist Montek Singh Ahluwalia to help augment State coffers

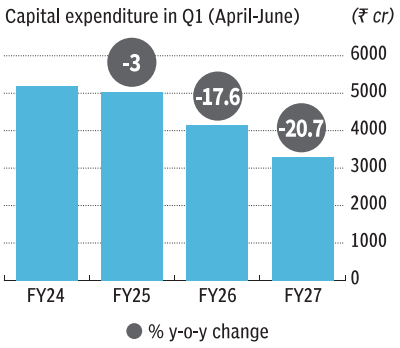
Tamil Nadu’s own tax revenue growth is stalling



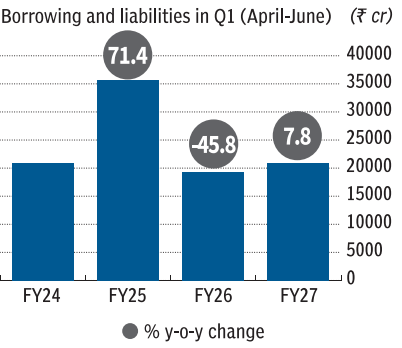
Revenue expenditure is marginally up in Q1



The capex slide continues



Debt in Q1 is higher than last year



The State govt also plans to borrow higher than last year in Q2

Indicative calendar of market borrowings of TN Government (in ₹ crore)



Source: CAG, RBI

LIC Mutual Fund to launch ₹500 crore SIF by October, targets ₹1 lakh crore AUM by FY27



RK Jha, MD and CEO,
LIC Mutual Fund Asset
Management Ltd BUJOY GHOSH

in its Assets Under Management, going from ₹16,526 crore in March 2023 to ₹50,875 crore as of July 31.

Despite this, LIC Mutual Fund currently accounts for a fraction of India’s overall mutual fund AUM, which industry estimates peg at around ₹82 Lakh crore.

“Our market share is much lower compared to other larger AMCs, possibly because we were not as serious earlier and due to factors such as administrative control and fund management. However, we are now approaching this aggressively and want to grow,” he said.

The company expects to scale its AUM by 2X to around ₹1 lakh crore by March 2027. “We had expec-

ted to reach this target by March 2026, but the market volatility since late 2024 has affected investor sentiment and inflows. If geopolitical uncertainties ease by the end of the year and equity markets recover, we can achieve the target,” he said.

Jha added that the growth will be supported by a combination of Systematic Investment Plans, as well as partnerships with banks and corporations.

EXPANSION PLANS

LIC Mutual Fund operates 42 funds across equity, hybrid and debt strategies. Equity funds account for nearly ₹20,000 crore in AUM, with debt and hybrid funds making up the rest.

To support AUM growth, it is also expanding its physical

presence, aiming for a footprint of 100 stores in the next few years. It currently has 58 offices across the country.

As for SIPs, Jha said that while volatile markets can lead to some stoppages, investor confidence in mutual funds remains strong, with overall SIP inflows at around ₹30,000 to ₹32,000 crore per month. On its recently launched thematic funds, he said that while the Manufacturing, consumption and multi-asset allocation funds have seen good uptake, the response has been more subdued for the technology fund given fears of AI-led disruptions.

Its AUM in Tamil Nadu is around ₹2,000 crore, which it plans to scale to around ₹20,000 crore in the next few years.

Soybean acreage recovers as July rains boost sowing

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Soybean acreage for the Kharif 2026 season has almost caught up with the previous year’s levels as sowing of the oilseed crop has increased in States such as Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh, among others.

As per the latest Agriculture Ministry data, total soybean acreage as on July 31 stood at 117.68 lakh ha, marginally lower (0.70 per cent) than the corresponding last year’s 118.52 lakh ha.

MIXED TRENDS

Trade body Soybean Processors Association of India (SOPA), which has been monitoring the crop through field surveys, has pegged the cropped area at 117.13 lakh ha.

Agri Ministry data showed that soybean acreage has surpassed last year’s levels in Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Gujarat, Telangana and Andhra Pradesh with farmers preferring to plant the oilseed crop aided by the pick-up in July rains, while the area has dropped in States like Maharashtra and Rajasthan.

In Madhya Pradesh, the



GAINING GROUND. As of July 31, soybean acreage stood at 117.68 lakh ha, marginally lower than 118.52 lakh ha a year ago

largest producing state, soybean acreage stood at 52.09 lakh ha as on July 31, about 2 per cent higher than the corresponding last year’s 51.08 lakh ha.

Rains in July have helped increase the area in Gujarat, where soybean area has risen by around 10 per cent to 2.79 lakh ha (2.54 lakh ha) and in Telangana by 3.80 per cent to 1.48 lakh ha (1.43 lakh ha).

In Uttar Pradesh and Andhra Pradesh, the soybean area has doubled this year at 0.80 lakh ha and 0.08 lakh ha, respectively.

However, in Maharashtra, the area is trailing by 3.84 per cent at 46.56 lakh ha (48.42 lakh ha), Rajasthan by 5.48 per cent at 9.17 lakh ha (9.70 lakh ha) and Karnataka

by 3.17 per cent at 4.09 lakh ha (4.22 lakh ha).

“Soybean crop sown during June has now reached the flowering stage in most soybean-growing areas. Overall, the crop condition is normal to good,” said DN Pathak, Executive Director, Soybean Processors Association of India (SOPA).

USE OF HERBICIDES

Healthy vegetative growth is being observed in most soybean-growing regions, and weed management has been effective through the use of Dora/Kolpa herbicides, resulting in largely weed-free fields. No major insect pest or disease incidence has been reported during field inspections, Pathak added.

Fusion CX plans to launch ₹1,000 cr IPO by October

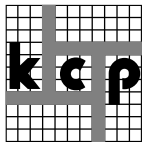
Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata

Global customer experience (CX) solutions provider Fusion CX is hopeful of launching its ₹1,000 crore IPO by October, subject to market conditions. The proposed public offer comprises a fresh issue of around ₹600 crore, while the remaining portion will be an offer for sale (OFS).

“As of now, we are looking at launching the IPO sometime in September-October. But we will see the market conditions. The market is not in anybody’s hands,” Fusion CX Co-Founder, MD and CEO Pankaj Dhanuka told *businessline*.

The company has reported a 128.3 per cent year-on-year jump in its net profit to ₹170 crore for FY26. It reported revenue from operations of ₹1,818 crore in the last financial year, posting a 36.8 per cent y-o-y growth.

“If you see from FY24 to FY26, our compound annual growth rate was around 35 per cent in the top line. And at present, the way business is growing, we are expecting this growth to continue for the next two to three years. And similarly, there has been a growth of over 50-60 per cent in EBITDA and profitability,” Dhanuka said.



The KCP Limited

CIN : L65991TN1941PLC001128

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STATEMENT OF UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30TH JUNE 2026

No.	PARTICULARS	STANDALONE				CONSOLIDATED			
		3 Months Ended		Year Ended		3 Months Ended		Year Ended	
		30.06.2026	31.03.2026	30.06.2025	31.03.2026	30.06.2026	31.03.2026	30.06.2025	31.03.2026
		Unaudited	Audited	Unaudited	Audited	Unaudited	Audited	Unaudited	Audited
1	Total Income	394.91	485.21	391.81	1,660.58	806.16	703.85	693.01	2,648.92
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before tax and Exceptional Items)	0.64	58.63	21.10	142.34	55.91	110.14	96.57	296.89
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional Items)	0.64	58.63	21.10	144.21	55.91	109.88	96.57	288.26
4	Net Profit for the period after tax (after exceptional items)	0.48	69.82	14.28	131.80	55.75	121.07	89.76	275.85
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period (comprising profit for the period after tax and other comprehensive income after tax)	0.06	69.66	15.32	131.93	50.42	170.88	82.22	362.80
6	Paid-up Equity Share Capital (Face value Rs.1/- per share)	12.89	12.89	12.89	12.89	12.89	12.89	12.89	12.89
7	Other Equity (as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of FY 2025-26)				828.04				1,768.99
8	Earnings Per Share (F V of Rs.1/- each) (Not Annualised) Basic & Diluted	0.04	5.42	1.11	10.22	2.86	6.60	4.92	15.29

The above is an extract of the detailed format of the Financial Results for the Quarter ended on 30th June 2026, filed with the Stock Exchanges under regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange websites (www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com) and on the Company’s website at www.kcp.co.in

Place : Chennai
Date : 3rd August, 2026

• Cement • Heavy Engineering • Sugar • Power • Hospitality



For and On behalf of the Board of Directors
Dr.V.L. Indira Dutt
Chairperson & Managing Director

QUICKLY.

KKR to Buy Integer Holdings for \$4.3 billion



Bengaluru: Private equity giant KKR will take Integer Holdings private in an all-cash deal valued at about \$5.7 billion, the medical-device outsourcing firm said on Monday. KKR's takeover of Integer comes amid continued private equity interest in healthcare, with buyout firms deploying significant reserves of untapped capital to pursue acquisitions and expand their portfolios. The deal with KKR is expected to close by the end of the year, Integer Holdings said. **REUTERS**

Visa to buy cyberspace player BioCatch for \$2.4 b

Bengaluru: Visa said it would buy fraud intelligence provider BioCatch for \$2.4 billion in cash from investment firm Permira and other investors, marking the card giant's latest effort to beef up its cybersecurity offerings. The deal would help the world's largest payment processor further bolster its existing cyber, fraud, risk and security offerings and enable it to help clients better protect themselves in an increasingly complex threat environment, Visa said. The BioCatch deal is expected to close by the end of Visa's fiscal second quarter of 2027. **REUTERS**

FSSAI pulls up alcobev players over non-permitted flavours

RIGHT LABELLING. Not tagging products as ‘flavoured/premix rum’ may be misleading

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has taken action against leading alcobev players for adding non-permitted flavours in products such as rum and whiskey that mimic their chemical composition, in violation of regulations. The action includes prohibition of sale order against products made in some manufacturing units, notices and inspection in certain States.

The regulator said that it has barred the sale of McDowell's No 1 Rum, Antiquity Blue Whiskey, Royal Challenge Whisky made by Diageo's United Spirits in Baramati and Madhya Pradesh. Similarly, prohibition of sale orders were issued again Khopoli unit of Mohan Rocky Springwater for three Old Monk Rum variants, which include the Legend, Gold Reserve, XXX Matured Rum, INBREW Beverages, Madhya Pradesh for Bagpiper Deluxe Whisky and Old Cask deluxe XXX Rum, Associated Alcohols & Breweries, Madhya Pradesh for brands, Central Province Whisky, McDowells No. 1 Celebration matured XXX Rum. Notices have also been issued to six other manufacturers in the State of Maharashtra in this case and further necessary action to follow soon, the food safety regulator stated



QUALITY IMPACTED. It also said that lab reports, post the testing of samples of these products, stated that “the addition of artificial flavours is masking its natural flavour and making the product substandard”

on Sunday. The action is State-specific because alcohol samples were tested from different States. FSSAI said manufacturers cannot add additives to mislead consumers and that its standards are instituted to ensure that the chemical composition of such beverages remains authentic to their raw material origins. It had first issued notices to alcobev players on this matter last month consequently some players are looking at legal recourse on this matter.

MIMIC NOT REAL Clarifying its position on this matter, the food safety regulator said that it found that some alcobev manufacturers are externally adding flavour, which mimic the product's inherent aroma and taste but are sold as a standard products, which misleads consumers. “The potential

need for the addition of such flavour is observed due to an existing malpractice wherein manufacturers, instead of creating products through maturation and/or from base materials such as molasses, malt, or grapes to develop their flavour naturally, use spirit/neutral alcohol primarily, which has no specific flavour and therefore add flavour externally,” it added.

The regulator said that such products are not “only sub-standard “but are also “misrepresented” as they are labelled under standard categories.

“At best, they can be identified as rum-flavoured Spirit or whiskey/flavoured Spirit, etc. Further, the front-of-the-pack completely fails to disclose the true nature of the product,” it added.

It also said that lab reports post testing of samples

of these products stated that “the addition of artificial flavours is masking its natural flavour and making the product substandard.” Also failing to name these products as “flavoured or premix rum” on the product label may mislead or be deceptive to the consumers, FSSAI’s statement added.

FSSAI stressed that the use of natural and nature-identical flavouring substances is permissible under the applicable regulations governing alcoholic beverages. “The present matter, however, does not pertain to a prohibition on the use of flavouring substances. Rather, it concerns the practice adopted by certain manufacturers of adding the flavour of the standardised alcoholic beverage itself, for instance, the addition of rum flavour in rum or whiskey flavour in whiskey,” it added.

AstraZeneca holds talks with Bristol Myers Squibb on \$400 billion deal

Reuters

UK drugmaker AstraZeneca has been exploring a deal to combine with US rival Bristol Myers Squibb, the *Financial Times* reported on Sunday, citing people familiar with the matter.

The deal could create one of the world's biggest pharmaceutical companies with a combined value of nearly \$400 billion.

The companies have held talks on a potential tie-up in recent months, the report said, adding that a deal could materialise soon, but could also be delayed or fall apart.

Reuters could not immediately verify the report. AstraZeneca declined to comment, while Bristol Myers did not immediately respond to a Reuters request for comment.

Last year, AstraZeneca unveiled plans for a direct US listing, aiming to capitalise on stronger valuations in the US market while remaining listed in London.

STRONG GROWTH

AstraZeneca's share price has more than quadrupled during Pascal Soriot's 14-year tenure as CEO, soaring above the wider FTSE 100 index and main British rival GSK.

Second-quarter results last week showed strong demand for cancer and rare disease drugs continues to drive growth.

Cancer treatments accounted for about \$25 billion in 2025 sales, nearly half of



GIANTS UNITE. Both companies have significant cancer drug portfolios, and a merger would be the biggest global pharma deal since 2020

the total, followed by cardiovascular, renal and metabolism treatments worth about \$12 billion.

Combining with Bristol Myers, whose shares are up around 44 per cent over the last year, could draw attention from antitrust regulators. Oncology drugs accounted for over 40 per cent of its overall sales in the first six months of 2026, and the two companies' cancer immunotherapies directly compete.

“I would expect a Trump FTC to scrutinise the merger and if there are significant overlaps in certain drugs and late stage pipeline overlaps it would require meaningful divestitures,” said antitrust lawyer Andre Barlow with DBM Law Group, referring to the US Federal Trade Commission.

Bristol Myers has been doing smaller deals to gain new drugs as it faces declining sales of older medicines,

some of which will soon face generic competition.

In 2019, Bristol Myers bought Celgene for about \$80 billion, acquiring its flagship blood cancer drug Revlimid, which became Bristol's top-selling product. Revlimid has already lost patent protection and its current top sellers — cancer immunotherapy Opdivo and blood thinner Eliquis — could lose patent protection by 2028.

The report of the potential deal comes about a dozen years after AstraZeneca fended off a takeover attempt by larger US rival Pfizer.

Large pharma deals have been rare in recent years, in part due to concerns about antitrust and US pressure to keep drug prices low. Besides Bristol and Celgene, AbbVie bought Allergan in 2020 and Takeda and Shire combined in 2019.

Honda emerges as largest 2-wheeler OEM in July’s retail registrations

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai



VROOMING AHEAD. HMSI overtook Hero MotoCorp in July as industry registrations rose 22.3% year-on-year despite a seasonal moderation from June

Honda Motorcycle & Scooter India (HMSI) emerged as India's top two-wheeler manufacturer by retail registrations in July, overtaking Hero MotoCorp for the first time in calendar year 2026. Honda's retail registrations rose 23 per cent year-on-year to 4,49,473 units, ahead of Hero MotoCorp's 4,19,456 units, which grew 20.6 per cent, according to Vahan data.

Overall two-wheeler registrations increased 22.3 per cent year-on-year to 17,34,624 units from 14,18,774 a year earlier. On a month-on-month basis, however, retail volumes declined 5.8 per cent from June's 18,41,713 units as monsoon seasonality weighed on demand.

Honda's July performance snapped Hero MotoCorp's six-month run at the top of the monthly Vahan retail rankings. Hero had led the market from January through June, driven by steady demand for its commuter motorcycle portfolio.

MARKET LEADERS

TVS Motor retained third place with 3,57,819 registrations, up 27.4 per cent year-on-year — the fastest growth among the top three manufacturers. Bajaj Auto followed with 1,71,790 registra-

tions, up 17.1 per cent, while Suzuki Motorcycle India recorded 97,732 units, a 4 per cent increase.

Royal Enfield continued its strong momentum, posting 90,501 registrations, up 25.3 per cent, while Yamaha recorded 64,873 units, an increase of 23.6 per cent year-on-year.

INDUSTRY OUTLOOK

Hemal Thakkar, Senior Director and Senior Practice Leader at Crisil Intelligence, said the two-wheeler industry is expected to clock retail sales of over 1.8 million units in July, reflecting 26-27 per cent year-on-year growth. The month-on-month decline, he said, was in line with seasonal trends, while underlying demand remained healthy.

“ICE two-wheeler retail sales are expected to reach

1.6-1.65 million units, growing more than 22 per cent year-on-year. However, volumes are likely to decline by around 3 per cent from June, reflecting the seasonal moderation seen across the industry. Even so, ICE vehicles will continue to account for the bulk of industry volumes,” Thakkar said.

Industry participants expect demand to remain resilient in the coming months, supported by rural recovery, replacement demand and the approaching festival season. Although registrations moderated sequentially in July, sustained double-digit annual growth suggests the domestic two-wheeler market remains on a firm footing, with conventional motorcycles and scooters continuing to dominate retail sales.

Maruti Suzuki banks on new plants, CNG push to sustain growth

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Maruti Suzuki is banking on expanded manufacturing capacity, robust demand for CNG vehicles and a recovery in the entry-level car segment to sustain growth after posting its highest-ever monthly sales in July.

The country's largest car-maker crossed the 2-lakh monthly sales milestone for the first time, selling 2,00,123 units in July. According to Partho Banerjee, Senior Executive Officer – Marketing & Sales, only two other automotive brands globally have achieved this feat in their home markets.

“We are not competing with anyone; we are competing with ourselves and trying to improve our benchmark month after month,” Banerjee said, noting that the company achieved the record despite production disruptions in June.

CNG, SUVs

Maruti expects its recently commissioned plants at Hansalpur and Kharkhoda to ease supply constraints over the next three to four months, helping it cater to festive season demand. Banerjee said the new facilities will ramp up production of SUVs and electric vehicles

while providing flexibility to manufacture multiple models based on market demand.

July sales were driven by broad-based demand across segments. Sales of small cars jumped 63 per cent, while SUV volumes grew 48 per cent year-on-year. The company also recorded its highest-ever monthly CNG sales of nearly 83,000 units, underscoring rising consumer preference for fuel-efficient vehicles amid elevated fuel prices.

Banerjee said the recently launched Brezza has received a strong response, attracting around 2,000 bookings a day across its three powertrain options. Maruti currently has a pending order book of 1.6 lakh units, with production teams working to shorten waiting periods.

OUTLOOK POSITIVE

Banerjee said GST changes, lower repo rates and income tax relief for entry-level buyers continue to support demand. He added that the company's expanded CNG portfolio has helped offset the impact of higher fuel prices, with CNG sales growing around 50 per cent. He estimated the passenger vehicle industry expanded to 4.65-4.7 lakh units in July from about 3.5 lakh units a year earlier.

Adani Green to focus on ops, derisks biz with Adani Energy handling marketing

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

Adani Green Energy (AGEL) is de-risking its business by moving away from merchant renewable power sales and locking about 4 GW of generation into long-term supply agreements with group company Adani Energy Solutions (AESL).

“Our strategy is to de-risk ourselves. We concentrate more on operational excellence, project execution and deploying capital efficiently rather than taking market risk,” Ashish Khanna, Chief Executive Officer of Adani Green, said recently.

The company indicated that the approach would also extend to future renewable and battery storage projects that were earlier earmarked for merchant or commercial and industrial (C&I) sales. AESL, too, during its recent earnings call, said it has tied up around 5 GW of renewable supply capacity, of which about 4 GW has been contracted from AGEL and the balance from third-party renewable generators.

The company will increasingly earn predictable returns through long-term supply contracts, with AESL assuming the responsibility of marketing power to end-users.

Executives said the agreements have been structured on an arm's-length, market-

linked basis and broadly mirror conventional long-term renewable PPAs.

Solar and wind contracts are typically for 25 years, while battery energy storage system agreements run for 15 years, providing long-term revenue visibility. Khanna said the strategy would continue beyond the initial 4-GW portfolio.

MERCHANT MARKETS

The company will continue to monetise electricity in merchant markets only for projects commissioned before their contracted PPAs become operational. For AESL, the arrangement forms the foundation of its rapidly expanding energy solutions platform, under which it aggregates renewable generation, battery storage and power procurement to supply customised energy solutions to utilities, industries and data centres.

“Our objective would be that most of the tied-up capacity on the purchase side has also tied up on our sales side,” said AESL Chief Executive Officer Kandarp Patel, adding that the company intends to convert most of its business into annuity-like revenues by matching long-term purchase agreements with long-term customer contracts. The company currently has around 350 MW of contracted C&I customers but said negotiations are at an advanced stage to secure long-term offtake agreements covering most of the renewable capacity already tied up. It expects demand to come increasingly from utilities, data centres and industrial consumers seeking round-the-clock renewable power backed by storage.

AESL said the energy solutions business has already transitioned into a full-scale vertical.

Alibaba unveils its largest AI model yet, DeepSeek’s latest model is ultra cheap

Reuters
Beijing

China's Alibaba on Monday unveiled its largest and most capable AI model to date, sending its shares surging, while a research firm said DeepSeek's latest product offers cut-throat pricing that is more than 100 times cheaper than Anthropic's Claude Fable 5.

The two developments highlight the rapid pace of advancement in artificial intelligence by Chinese tech firms, which are locked in a fierce and fast-moving battle to build more powerful systems without making them prohibitively expensive to

run. Both models — Alibaba's Qwen3.8-Max and DeepSeek's V4-Flash — underline Chinese commitment to open-weight models as the firms seek to gain traction among developers globally.

MANY PARAMETERS

“Chinese AI companies have found an important market. Many business workflows do not need the industry's very best model,” said Lian Jye Su, Chief Analyst at research firm Omdia.

“They need models that are good enough, affordable, transparent and accessible, and open-weight models help meet that demand.”

Alibaba's new Qwen3.8-

Max immediately shot up leaderboards assessing the capabilities of AI models after being unveiled on Monday, helping its shares jump seven per cent in Hong Kong trade.

The model has 2.4 trillion parameters, the numerical settings a model learns from data and uses to recognise patterns, generate answers, and carry out tasks.

POPULAR MODELS

Qwen3.8-Max was unveiled on crowdsourced, model-comparison platform Arena.AI.

It soon became the highest-ranking Chinese model in terms of text models, though it still lags Claude

Fable5 and three Opus variants which are all from Anthropic.

DeepSeek's V4-Flash model, released on Friday, is by far the least expensive to run on benchmark tests among well-known models globally, according to research firm Artificial Analysis. V4-Flash charges \$0.14 per million input tokens and \$0.28 per million output tokens, according to San Francisco-based Artificial Analysis.

Artificial Analysis estimated V4-Flash's average cost at 3 cents per test, compared with 86 cents for Kimi K3, \$1.86 for OpenAI's GPT-5.6 Sol and \$3.15 for Claude Fable 5.



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SAMBHV STEEL TUBES LIMITED

CIN no. : L27320CT2017PLC007918.

Registered Office: Office No. 501 to 511 Harshit Corporate, Amanaka, Raipur (C.G) India, 492001, Tel.: 0771-2222360, Email: cs@sambhv.com, Website: www.sambhv.com

Statement of Unaudited Consolidated & Standalone Financial Results for the Quarter Ended June 30, 2026.

The Unaudited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results of Sambhv Steel Tubes Limited (“the Company”) along with the Limited Review Reports of the Statutory Auditors of the Company for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at their Meetings held on August 03, 2026, in terms of Regulation 33 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.

The results along with the Limited Review Reports have been posted on the Company's website at <https://www.sambhv.com/financial-performance.php> and on stock exchanges website www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com. The results can also be accessed by scanning the QR Code.



Place: Raipur
Date: August 03, 2026

Note: The above information is in accordance with Regulation 33 read with Regulation 47(1) of SEBI (Listing Obligation and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015.

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors of Sambhv Steel Tubes Limited

Sd/-
Vikas Kumar Goyal
Managing Director and CEO
DIN: 00318182

Anthropic’s Claude to process queries within India via Amazon Bedrock

GAME-CHANGER. Bringing in-country inference to India is a turning point for enterprise AI: MD Irina Ghose

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Anthropic has made Claude available with in-country inference in India via Amazon Bedrock, AWS’ platform for building generative AI applications, allowing requests to be processed on local servers, rather than sending the data to servers overseas.

Anthropic also has partnerships with State governments, public health programmes, and agencies that serve citizens directly, involving personal data that cannot leave the country.

In-country inference opens the door to deeper work here.

DATA RESIDENCY

As per the company, India is one of the largest markets for Claude, with the local developer community doing technically complex AI work. A top ask from organisations has been for options to access Claude locally.

“Bringing Claude inference to India is a turning point for enterprise AI in this country,” said Irina Ghose, Managing Director of India, Anthropic.

“India’s banks, insurers, telecoms, public and government agencies steward the data of a billion people. When that data can stay in India, AI moves from pilots into the systems that matter most. Adding in-country inference marks a significant step forward in what we are building here — a growing local team, strong perform-



TECH HUB. India is one of the largest markets for Claude, with the local developer community doing technically complex AI work

ance in Indian languages, and partnerships that put this technology to work for India.”

Running Claude inferencing in-country gives Indian organisations the certainty to serve customers in highly-regulated verticals such as banks, insurers, and public and government agencies.

Meanwhile, Sandeep Dutta, President, AWS India and South Asia, said that with Anthropic’s Claude now available for in-country inferencing through Amazon Bedrock, institutions from banks to government agencies can deploy it on the same trusted infrastructure they already run their most critical workloads on, unlocking new possibilities in citizen services and digital transformation.

Jagdish Sharma, Co-Founder & CEO, Cedro Sys-

tems, noted that as AI becomes an integral part of workplace learning and employee productivity, enterprises are increasingly looking for solutions that align with their governance, compliance and data residency requirements.

“The availability of in-country inference for Claude in India is expected to strengthen enterprise confidence, enabling organisations to accelerate AI adoption across learning, knowledge management and workforce productivity while meeting their security and compliance expectations,” he said.

Aniket Tapre, Founder and CEO at Neural Arc, highlighted that data residency was the last real compliance objection standing between Indian enterprises and frontier AI.

of India runs a Claude-powered testing sandbox, giving members across critical sectors a shared environment to test codebases and supply chains. Open-source infrastructure, often maintained by small teams where vulnerabilities can go undetected for years, is getting Claude’s help too: MOSIP, the platform underpinning national digital ID systems for more than 200 million people, and OpenG2P, which delivers citizen benefits globally, have made Claude integral to how code enters their platforms.

“Six months after signing the New Delhi Frontier AI Impact Commitments, we are making progress, including a company-wide effort to improve Claude’s performance in India’s most widely-spoken languages. In a pilot earlier this year, Karya worked with native speakers and domain experts to evaluate Claude models across Indian languages in agriculture use cases, showing how community feedback can catch issues automated evaluations miss. We will build on these findings to improve our models across the languages and contexts that matter for India,” it said in the company blog.

When Anthropic launched the Claude Partner Network globally in March 2026, India had some of the highest registration numbers globally. This week, in Bengaluru, Anthropic is holding its first Claude Certification for Partners, aiming to certify 5,000 people.

Industry veteran Willie Walsh to pilot IndiGo’s global ambitions

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

In a nearly five-decade-long aviation career, Willie Walsh has donned several hats — Boeing 737 captain, pilot union negotiator, chief executive officer of airlines and finally Director-General of the International Air Transport Association, a lobby group of 370 airlines.

SPOTLIGHT.

Walsh (64) is expected to put his immense experience into action as he leads IndiGo in its next phase of growth. He took over as Chief Executive Officer on Monday, on the eve of the airline’s 20th anniversary.

As CEO, Walsh will lead the airline’s overall management and strategic direction with a focus on accelerating its global growth trajectory and driving operational excellence, among others, IndiGo said in a statement on his joining.

“Walsh is inheriting a strong platform. IndiGo already has what many competitors would envy: A powerful domestic network, a disciplined low-cost operating base and systems robust enough to support scale,” said Shashank Nigam, founder and CEO of aviation strategy firm Simplifying.

IndiGo is India’s largest airline with 440 plus aircraft and a network of 142 destinations. Last fiscal, it flew 123 million passengers. It plans to scale up its fleet to 550-plus aircraft and transport 200 million passengers annually by 2030.



Willie Walsh has taken over as the CEO of IndiGo

It has over 900-plus planes on order, including 60 Airbus A350s that would enable it to fly non-stop to the US or Australia.

Ongoing geo-political tensions, however, have put a speed breaker on IndiGo’s growth plans. It ended its Boeing 787 aircraft damp leases and suspended London flights effective October 25.

Walsh himself is no stranger to challenges. He is credited with reviving the Irish airline Aer Lingus from the brink of bankruptcy in the wake of the 9/11 attack.

‘SLASHER WALSH’

Under him, Aer Lingus restructured operations, adopted low fares, axed jobs and aggressively cut costs, earning him the nickname ‘Slasher Walsh’.

There were more challenges in his next stint as the CEO of British Airways, including the global financial crisis of 2008.

There were crises, too, like the volcanic eruption in April 2010 that closed European airspace. Walsh himself travelled in a test flight, convincing the UK’s aviation regulator to lift the curbs.

However, everything was not hunky dory. The opening of Heathrow airport’s Terminal 5 in 2008 was billed as a disaster due to the collapse of the baggage handling system. Labour disputes culminated in a cabin crew strike in 2010, denting the British Airways brand.

DRIVING GROWTH

Yet, Walsh was successful in driving strategic growth and profits primarily by keeping costs low.

“Under Willie, British Airways saw a much improved performance and increased profitability. He was the founding CEO of International Airlines Group (that was formed after the merger of British Airways and Iberia in 2011), which has become the most successful European airline network group,” said John Strickland, Director, JLS Consulting.

“IndiGo is focused not only on restoring its reputation after last year’s meltdown, but also on ensuring strong foundations for growth. This will be a key expectation against which Willie will be judged,” he added.

“His (Willie’s) extensive experience in the aviation industry, combined with his operational and strategic expertise, will be instrumental as IndiGo accelerates its international expansion strategy. I am confident that under his leadership IndiGo will further strengthen its standing on the global aviation stage and increasingly contribute to the continued development of the Indian aviation sector,” said IndiGo’s Managing Director Rahul Bhatia.

Dr Reddy’s registers innovative therapy in South Africa for rare form of cancer

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Dr Reddy’s Laboratories has registered an innovative immunotherapy in South Africa for the treatment of recurrent or metastatic nasopharyngeal carcinoma, a rare and aggressive form of head and neck cancer.

“The registration represents an important step forward for patients living with recurrent or metastatic nasopharyngeal carcinoma and reflects our commitment to expanding access to advanced oncology treatments in South Africa,” Rashem Mothilal, General Manager, Dr Reddy’s Laboratories, South Africa, said on Monday.

According to the Cancer Association of South Africa, one in four South Africans

will be diagnosed with cancer during their lifetime.

Unlike chemotherapy, which kills rapidly dividing cancer cells but can also affect healthy cells such as those in the bone marrow, digestive tract and hair follicles, immunotherapy takes a different approach. It is a form of biological therapy that helps the body’s immune system recognise and fight cancer more effectively.

will be diagnosed with cancer during their lifetime.

Unlike chemotherapy, which kills rapidly dividing cancer cells but can also affect healthy cells such as those in the bone marrow, digestive tract and hair follicles, immunotherapy takes a different approach. It is a form of biological therapy that helps the body’s immune system recognise and fight cancer more effectively.





PROFIT AFTER TAX*
₹337 crore
Up By **37%**



LOAN BOOK*
₹94,936 crore
Up By **19%**



REVENUE FROM OPERATIONS*
₹2,250 crore
Up By **15%**



NET WORTH*
₹14,133 crore
Up By **14%**

EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS (STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED) FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026

(₹ in crores)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Standalone				Consolidated			
		Quarter ended		Year ended		Quarter ended		Year ended	
		30-Jun-26	31-Mar-26	30-Jun-25	31-Mar-26	30-Jun-26	31-Mar-26	30-Jun-25	31-Mar-26
		(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)
1.	Total Income from Operations	2,249.54	2,180.90	1,959.53	8,337.48	2,250.60	2,181.28	1,959.84	8,338.89
2.	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	412.72	619.26	304.63	2,336.92	413.75	619.14	304.84	2,337.58
3.	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	412.72	619.26	304.63	2,336.92	413.75	619.14	304.84	2,337.58
4.	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	337.50	492.75	246.68	1,873.34	338.53	492.62	246.88	1,874.00
5.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/(Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	277.65	577.74	265.37	1,993.46	278.30	579.20	266.21	1,997.15
6.	Paid-up Equity Share Capital (Face Value of ₹10/- each)	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23
7.	Other Equity	11,323.27	10,972.12	9,592.63	10,972.12	11,327.96	10,976.19	9,593.20	10,976.19
8.	Securities Premium Account (net)	2,737.56	2,737.56	2,737.57	2,737.56	2,737.56			
9.	Net Worth	14,132.50	13,781.35	12,401.86	13,781.35	14,137.19			
10.	Paid-up Debt Capital/Outstanding Debt	79,002.01	77,845.63	66,398.32	77,845.63	79,058.77			
11.	Debt Equity Ratio	5.59	5.65	5.35	5.65	5.59			
12.	Earnings Per Share (of ₹10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)								
	A. Basic:	1.20	1.76	0.91	6.73	1.21	1.76	0.91	6.73
	B. Diluted:	1.20	1.76	0.91	6.73	1.21	1.76	0.91	6.73
13.	Debtenture Redemption Reserve	-	-	439.01	-	-	-	439.01	-

Notes:

a) The above results have been approved by the Board of Directors in its meeting held on 03.08.2026 and have been subject to limited review by the Joint Statutory Auditors of the Company.

b) The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly financial results filed with Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 & 52 of the SEBI LODR Regulations. The full format of the said financial results are available on the website of the Company, www.ireda.in/financial-results, and on the websites of the Stock Exchanges, www.bseindia.com & www.nseindia.com.

c) For the other line items referred in Regulation 52(4) of the SEBI LODR Regulations, pertinent disclosures have been made to the Stock Exchanges and can be accessed at www.bseindia.com & www.nseindia.com, respectively.

Date: 03.08.2026

Place: New Delhi

INDIAN RENEWABLE ENERGY DEVELOPMENT AGENCY LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)

Registered Office: 1st Floor, Core-4A, East Court, India Habitat Centre, Lodhi Road, New Delhi-110003. Tel.: 011-24682206-19, Fax: 011-24682202

Corporate Office: 3rd Floor, August Kranti Bhawan, Bhikaji Cama Place, New Delhi-110066. Tel.: 011-26717400-12, Fax: 011-26717416

Business Centre: NBCC Office Complex, Office Block No. II, Plate B, 7th Floor, East Kidwai Nagar, New Delhi-110023. Tel.: 011-24347729-99

Website: www.ireda.in | CIN: L65100DL1987GOI027265

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For and on Behalf of the Board of Directors

Sd/-

Dr. B.K. Mohanty

Chairman & Managing Director (Additional Charge)

Director (Finance)

DIN No.: 08816532

SCAN THE QR CODE FOR ACCESSING FINANCIAL RESULTS



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12.25%
On Cumulative Basis Under Option X, 72 Months, Tds As Applicable.

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**The Issue shall remain open for subscription on Working Days from 10:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time), during the period indicated above, except that the Issue may close on such earlier date or extended date as may be decided by the Board of Directors or Finance and Management Committees of our Company, subject to relevant approvals (subject to a minimum period of two working days and a maximum period of 10 working days from the date of opening of this Issue). In the event of early closure of the Issue, our Company shall ensure that notices of such early closure or extension is given to the prospective investors through an advertisement in a national daily newspaper and a regional daily newspaper in Tamil Nadu where the registered office is located, with wide circulation on or before such earlier date or extended date of closure. Application Forms for the Issue will be accepted only from 10:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time) or such extended time as may be permitted by the Stock Exchange, on Working Days during the Issue Period. On the Issue Closing Date, Application Forms will be accepted only between 10:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m., and uploaded until 5:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time) or such extended time as may be permitted by the Stock Exchange.*

Issue Structure: (For detailed Issue Structure refer Prospectus dated July 28, 2026)

Face value : ₹ 1,000 each	Minimum application size : ₹ 10,000 (10 NCDs) & in multiples of 1 NCD thereafter
Tenure (months) : 13, 24, 36, 60 and 72	Payout options : Monthly, Annually & Cumulative
Schemes : 10 schemes with 10 ISINs	

THE ISSUE

PUBLIC ISSUE BY OUR COMPANY OF 10,00,000 SECURED, REDEEMABLE, NON-CONVERTIBLE DEBENTURES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1,000 EACH, ("NCDs") AT PAR, FOR AN AMOUNT UP TO ₹5,00,00,000 THOUSAND ("BASE ISSUE SIZE") WITH AN OPTION TO RETAIN OVERSUBSCRIPTION UP TO ₹5,00,00,000 THOUSAND, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹10,00,00,000 THOUSAND. HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "ISSUE SIZE". THE ISSUE IS BEING MADE PURSUANT TO THE PROVISIONS OF SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA ACT, 1956 AND LISTING OF NON-CONVERTIBLE SECURITIES REGULATIONS, 2021. AS AMENDED. THE COMPANIES ACT, 2013 AND RULES MADE THEREUNDER TO THE EXTENT NOTIFIED AND THE SEBI MASTER CIRCULAR AS AMENDED FROM TIME TO TIME, THE ISSUE IS NOT PROPOSED TO BE UNDERWRITTEN.

COUPON RATE: (MONTHLY OPTIONS)

- OPTION IV**: 11.50% PER ANNUM 60 MONTHS
- OPTION III**: 11.00% PER ANNUM 36 MONTHS
- OPTION II**: 10.50% PER ANNUM 24 MONTHS
- OPTION I**: 10.00% PER ANNUM 13 MONTHS

**Indicating coupon rates for monthly options only. Refer Prospectus dated July 28, 2026 to see effective yield for monthly, annually and cumulative options.*

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